









Modelling Financial Markets

Chapter 18: Systemic Risk and Networks



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When Does One Bank's Distress Become the System's Problem?

From one bank to the system

- **Systemic risk**: the risk that the distress of one or several institutions impairs the financial system as a whole, and through it the real economy
- An **externality**: a bank does not pay for the losses its failure imposes on others
- Three families of measures (survey: Benoit, Colliard, Hurlin & Pérignon (2017))
  - **Exposure**: what does the bank lose when the market crashes? MES (its average loss on crash days), SRISK (its capital shortfall in a crisis)
  - **Contribution**: how much worse is the system when the bank is in distress? ΔCoVaR (CoVaR: the Value-at-Risk, VaR, of the system conditional on the bank)
  - **Connectedness**: through which links do shocks travel? Spillover and tail networks

The Plan of the Chapter: Tail Losses and Financial Networks

Two parts

- Part I: data and conventions; exposure (MES, LRMES, the MES of a crisis lasting months, SRISK); contribution (CoVaR, ΔCoVaR) and how far rankings can be trusted
- Part II: spillover networks, the Financial Risk Meter, stress tests and climate risk, a case study on quantile connectedness, one pass of the discovery loop with AI (artificial intelligence)
- Textbooks: Franke, Härdle & Hafner (2019), Härdle, Chen & Overbeck (2017)

Bank Runs: Northern Rock 2007 and Silicon Valley Bank 2023



Depositors queue outside a Northern Rock branch, Brighton, 14 September 2007

Photo: Dominic Alves (2007); CC BY 2.0; Wikimedia Commons

- Northern Rock (2007): a British mortgage lender hit by the freeze in funding markets after the US subprime losses; depositors queued to withdraw their savings
- SVB (2023): a digital run; the FDIC (Federal Deposit Insurance Corporation) took the bank over on 10 March FDIC (2023); two days later all depositors of SVB and Signature Bank were protected on **systemic** risk grounds Federal Reserve Board (2023)

Through Which Channels Does Contagion Travel?

- One bank's distress becomes systemic through three channels
  - **Funding runs**: depositors and lenders withdraw from any bank that looks similar
  - **Common exposures** and **fire sales**: forced selling lowers prices for every holder
  - **Counterparty links**: one bank's liability is another bank's asset, so a default passes losses to its creditors

Thirteen Banks, Three Markets: Prices and Log Returns

Group	Banks (ticker, used in some charts)	Market index
US banks	JPMorgan (JPM), Bank of America (BAC), Citigroup (C), Goldman Sachs (GS), Morgan Stanley (MS), Wells Fargo (WFC)	S&P 500
European banks	Deutsche Bank (DBK), BNP Paribas (BNP), Santander (SAN), ING (INGA), HSBC (HSBA)	Euro Stoxx 50
Romanian banks	Banca Transilvania (TLV), BRD-Groupe Société Générale (BRD; "BRD-Groupe SG" in charts)	BET
Volatility	the VIX index (implied volatility of the S&P 500)	

- Daily prices, January 2010 to 18 September 2026, adjusted for dividends and splits
  - Aligned on 3 960 common trading days first, then daily log returns $r_t = 100(\ln P_t - \ln P_{t-1})$, in %
- Special cases
  - Romanian banks, traded on the Bucharest Stock Exchange (BVB, index BET): days without trades removed
  - Historical stress scenarios for the international banks start in 2007

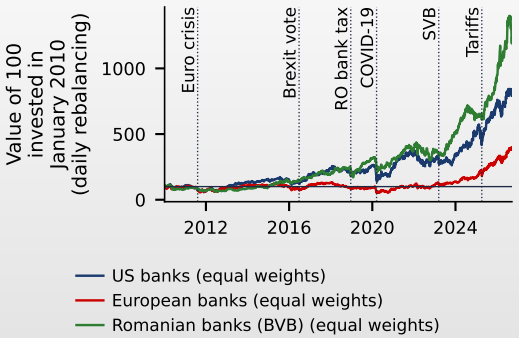
Losses as Positive Numbers and the System Portfolio (1/2)

- Return X, loss $L = -X$; the level α is a **tail probability** (Chapter 7)
  - We write VaR 1%, CoVaR 1%, MES 5%
  - $\mathrm{VaR}_\alpha(X) = -q_\alpha(X)$, with q_α the α-quantile of X
  - VaR, CoVaR and MES are positive numbers when they are losses

Losses as Positive Numbers and the System Portfolio (2/2)

- **System** return X^{sys}: the equal-weighted portfolio of the other banks of the same region
  - $X^{sys} = \frac{1}{n} \sum_j X_j$, the average daily log return of the n other banks
  - A linear aggregate: a first-order approximation of the log return of the daily rebalanced portfolio
  - CoVaR is stated for this aggregate, while MES conditions on the regional market index

Three Banking Systems, 2010–2026



- Equal-weighted portfolios of the banks of each region, rebalanced daily
  - Vertical lines mark the episodes used in this chapter
- 100 invested in January 2010 became 791 (US), 384 (Europe), 1 233 (Romania)
  - Maximum drawdown: US 51% (2011-11-23), Europe 61% (2020-04-21), Romania 47% (2012-06-06)
  - Annualised volatility: 29%, 30%, 23%; indices: 18%, 21%, 18%
- The falls are **simultaneous**: euro crisis, COVID-19, 2023 bank failures
  - Romanian banks also have their own shock: the bank-tax announcement of December 2018 (label "RO bank tax")

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How Much Does a Bank Lose When the Market Crashes?

- **Exposure**: the loss of the bank given a market crisis, not its stand-alone VaR
  - What matters are the banks that run out of capital exactly when the system needs it
- Three steps, from one crash day to a crisis
  - MES: the average loss of the bank on the worst 5% of market days, the level used by Acharya, Pedersen, Philippon & Richardson (2017)
  - LRMES: the loss of the bank in a crisis lasting weeks or months
  - SRISK: the capital the bank would lack after that loss

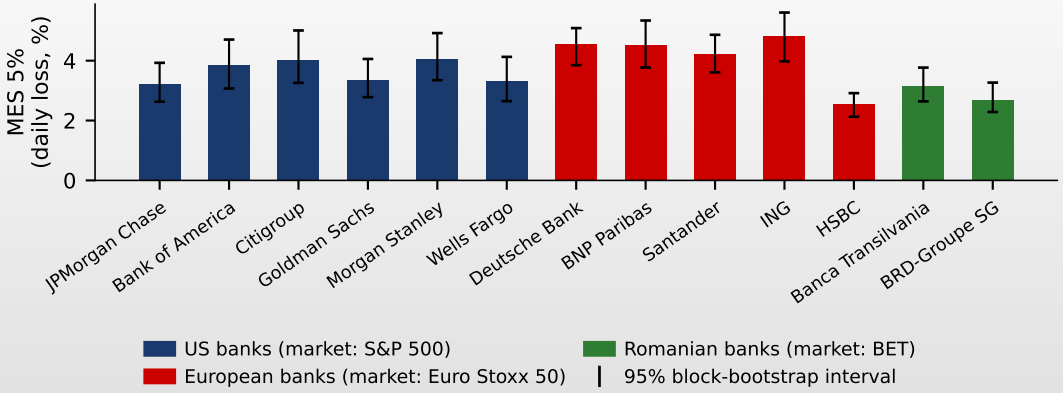
Marginal Expected Shortfall and the Euler Property (1/2)

- **MES** (Marginal Expected Shortfall) of bank i at level α Acharya, Pedersen, Philippon & Richardson (2017)
  - $\mathrm{MES}_{i,\alpha} = -\mathbb{E}[X_i \mid X_m \leq q_\alpha(X_m)]$
  - The average loss of the bank on the worst α share of days for the market m
  - Market m: S&P 500 for US banks, Euro Stoxx 50 for European banks, BET for Romanian banks

Marginal Expected Shortfall and the Euler Property (2/2)

- Why "marginal": **if** the conditioning variable is the portfolio itself, $m = \sum_i w_i X_i$, then $\mathrm{ES}_\alpha(X_m) = \sum_i w_i \, \mathrm{MES}_{i,\alpha}$ (Euler allocation; proof in the Appendix)
  - w_i: portfolio weights; $\mathrm{ES}_\alpha(X_m) = -\mathbb{E}[X_m \mid X_m \leq q_\alpha(X_m)]$: the average loss of m on its own worst α days
  - Our market indices are **not** portfolios of these 13 banks: here MES measures **exposure**, not a share of the index ES
- Historical estimate: average $-X_i$ over the days with $X_m \leq \hat{q}_\alpha(X_m)$; with $\alpha = 5\%$ and 3 960 days, about 200 days

MES 5% of Thirteen Banks (1/2)



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MES 5% of Thirteen Banks (2/2)

- Average daily loss of each bank on the worst 5% of days for its market index, 2010–2026
  - 95% intervals: moving-block bootstrap, blocks of 20 days
- US banks: 3.22% (JPMorgan) to 4.04% (Morgan Stanley); Europe up to 4.81% (ING)
  - Same days, market: 2.72% (S&P 500), 3.16% (Euro Stoxx 50): banks lose more
- HSBC is the exception in Europe (2.54%, below the index)
  - A London listing with business concentrated in Asia
- Banca Transilvania 3.14%, BRD 2.69%; BET itself 2.70%

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From MES to a Crisis: LRMES (1/2)

- **LRMES** (Long-Run MES): the expected fall of the bank's market equity in a crisis
  - $\mathrm{LRMES}_{i,t} = -\mathbb{E}_t\left[R_{i,t+\mathbf{1}:t+h} \mid R_{m,t+\mathbf{1}:t+h} < C\right]$, crisis: a market fall below C over h days
  - $R_{i,t+\mathbf{1}:t+h}$, $R_{m,t+\mathbf{1}:t+h}$: arithmetic returns (simple percentage changes over the h days, not log returns) of bank i and of the market from $t+1$ to $t+h$
  - Acharya, Engle & Richardson (2012): $C = -40\%$ over six months; Brownlees & Engle (2017): $C = -10\%$ over $h = 22$ days

From MES to a Crisis: LRMES (2/2)

- Shortcut of Acharya, Engle & Richardson (2012), used when no simulation is available
  - $\mathrm{LRMES}_i \approx 1 - \exp(-18 \times \mathrm{MES}_i^{2\%})$
  - $\mathrm{MES}_i^{2\%}$: average daily loss of the bank on days when the market falls by more than 2% (in decimals)
  - Example: $\mathrm{MES}^{2\%} = 3\%$ gives $1 - e^{-0.54} = 41.7\%$; the 18 is a calibration constant
  - What the 18 does: it turns a one-day tail loss into the loss over the six-month, -40% crisis, assuming the bank's beta to the market stays constant over the crisis
- Shortcut on our banks: 37% (HSBC) to 58% (ING); JPMorgan 48%, Banca Transilvania 52%
  - Market falls of more than 2%: 138 days in the US, 196 in the euro area, 111 on the BVB

SRISK and the Break-Even Leverage (1/4)

- **SRISK** (systemic risk): the capital a bank would lack in a severe market crisis
- A bank must keep equity of at least a share k of its quasi-assets Brownlees & Engle (2017)
  - Quasi-assets: book debt D plus market equity W
  - $\mathrm{SRISK}_i = k\,D_i - (1-k)(1-\mathrm{LRMES}_i)\,W_i$, assuming debt is not renegotiated in the crisis
  - Equivalent form: $k[D_i + (1-\mathrm{LRMES}_i)W_i] - (1-\mathrm{LRMES}_i)W_i$, the capital required after the crisis minus the capital left
  - $k = 8\%$ for US firms Brownlees & Engle (2017); $k = 5.5\%$ for European firms (IFRS, International Financial Reporting Standards, balance sheets report larger assets than US GAAP, Generally Accepted Accounting Principles) Engle, Jondeau & Rockinger (2015)
  - Why larger: IFRS allows less **netting** of derivative assets against liabilities with the same counterparty, so the same bank reports a larger gross balance sheet; a lower k on larger assets keeps the requirement comparable

SRISK and the Break-Even Leverage (2/4)

- Positive SRISK = capital shortfall
  - SRISK of the system: the sum of the positive values
  - V-Lab, New York University Stern School of Business publishes it for large banks, from their balance sheets

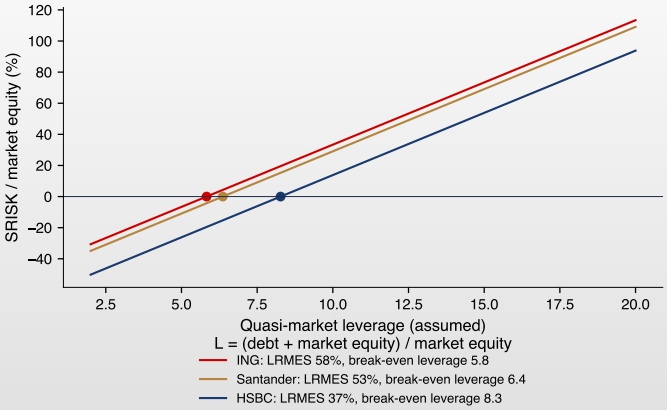
SRISK and the Break-Even Leverage (3/4)

- Divide by W; quasi-market leverage $\Lambda = (D + W)/W$
  - $\dfrac{\mathrm{SRISK}}{W} = k(\Lambda - 1) - (1 - k)(1 - \mathrm{LRMES})$
  - $\Lambda - 1 = D/W$ is debt per unit of market equity
- SRISK is positive once leverage exceeds the **break-even leverage**
  - $\Lambda^* = 1 + \dfrac{(1 - k)(1 - \mathrm{LRMES})}{k}$

SRISK and the Break-Even Leverage (4/4)

- Example: $D = 900$, $W = 100$ (so $\Lambda = 10$), $\mathrm{LRMES} = 41.7\%$
  - $\mathrm{SRISK} = 0.08 \times 900 - 0.92 \times (1 - 41.7\%) \times 100 = 72 - 53.6 = 18.4$
  - $\Lambda^* = 7.7 < \Lambda = 10$: a shortfall
- Our data contain prices, not balance sheets
  - We report Λ^* from the estimated LRMES and treat leverage as an **assumption**

SRISK as a Function of Leverage (1/3)



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SRISK as a Function of Leverage (2/3)

- Banks with the highest, median and lowest LRMES; dots mark Λ^*
  - Leverage on the horizontal axis is assumed, not observed
- With $k = 8\%$ and the shortcut LRMES (six-month crisis, market -40%): $\Lambda^* = 5.8$ (ING), 6.4 (Santander), 8.3 (HSBC)
  - US: JPMorgan 7.0, Morgan Stanley 6.0; Romania: Banca Transilvania 6.5, BRD 7.1

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SRISK as a Function of Leverage (3/3)

- Quasi-leverage above $\Lambda^* = 5.8$–8.3, i.e. debt $D/W = \Lambda - 1$ above 4.8–7.3 times market equity: new capital needed in a 40% market crash
- With $k = 5.5\%$ the thresholds rise (ING 8.2, HSBC 11.9)
  - The prudential ratio is a policy choice, and SRISK depends on it
- Limits: LRMES extrapolates daily data; market equity itself falls in a crisis

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LRMES via GJR–GARCH and DCC: the Model (1/2)

- Model of Brownlees & Engle (2017): zero-mean daily log returns of the bank and of the market
  - GJR–GARCH(1,1) volatilities Glosten, Jagannathan & Runkle (1993); GARCH: generalized autoregressive conditional heteroskedasticity
  - A DCC(1,1) correlation (DCC: dynamic conditional correlation) Engle (2002); two-step quasi-maximum likelihood (QML)
- Volatility, for the bank and for the market: today's variance reacts to yesterday's squared return, more after a fall
  - $\sigma_t^2 = \omega + (\alpha + \gamma\, 1\{r_{t-1} < 0\})\, r_{t-1}^2 + \beta\, \sigma_{t-1}^2$
  - σ_t^2: conditional variance of the return r_t; $\omega > 0$: constant; α: reaction to a shock (here not the tail level); $\gamma > 0$: extra reaction after a fall (leverage effect); β: persistence; $1\{\cdot\}$: 1 if the condition holds, else 0

LRMES via GJR–GARCH and DCC: the Model (2/2)

- Correlation: a GARCH-type recursion for the matrix Q_t, rescaled to a correlation
  - $Q_t = (1 - a - b)\, S + a\, \epsilon_{t-\mathbf{1}} \epsilon_{t-\mathbf{1}}^{\top} + b\, Q_{t-\mathbf{1}}$, $\rho_t = Q_{\mathbf{12},t} / \sqrt{Q_{\mathbf{11},t} Q_{\mathbf{22},t}}$
  - $\epsilon_t = (r_{it}/\sigma_{it}, r_{mt}/\sigma_{mt})^{\top}$: standardised returns; S: their sample correlation matrix; a: reaction, b: persistence of the correlation; $\rho_{\underline{t}}$: today's bank–market correlation
  - S is written $\bar{Q}$ in Engle (2002), as the sample covariance of ϵ_t; standardised returns have variance close to 1, so the two nearly coincide and Q_t stays on a correlation scale

LRMES via GJR–GARCH and DCC: Simulation (1/2)

- Simulation (details: Appendix)
  - Resample **pairs** of standardised innovations $(\xi_{it}, \epsilon_{mt})$ of bank and market
  - ϵ_{mt}: the standardised market shock; ξ_{it}: the part of the bank shock uncorrelated with the market
  - Filter h days ahead from today's σ^2 and ρ; keep the paths with $R_{m,t+\mathbf{1}:t+h} < C$
  - LRMES = minus the average bank return over these crisis paths
  - Resampling pairs keeps the tail dependence that the Normal distribution misses

LRMES via GJR–GARCH and DCC: Simulation (2/2)

- Data to 2026-09-18; paths per market
  - 200 000 paths of 22 days ($C = -10\%$); 400 000 paths of 126 days ($C = -40\%$)
- Probability of the 22-day crisis
  - Today: 1.3% (S&P 500), 4.3% (Euro Stoxx 50), 4.0% (BET)
  - On 31 March 2020: 12%, 19%, 8%

LRMES by Simulation: Thirteen Banks (1/2)

Bank	LRMES today	90% range	LRMES 31.03.2020	ρ_T	Λ^* (22 days)
JPMorgan	10.6	$[-2, 25]$	23.7	0.53	11.3
Bank of America	14.3	$[-4, 35]$	23.2	0.44	10.9
Citigroup	13.0	$[-1, 28]$	32.8	0.54	11.0
Goldman Sachs	16.5	$[1, 34]$	25.0	0.65	10.6
Morgan Stanley	16.3	$[1, 32]$	27.2	0.65	10.6
Wells Fargo	6.7	$[-8, 24]$	22.9	0.32	11.7
Deutsche Bank	14.4	$[2, 28]$	25.7	0.66	10.8
BNP Paribas	15.6	$[2, 33]$	28.5	0.68	10.7
Santander	16.6	$[3, 34]$	26.4	0.76	10.6
ING	12.5	$[1, 27]$	32.9	0.68	11.1
HSBC	8.3	$[-2, 19]$	10.9	0.58	11.5
Banca Transilvania	12.4	$[-2, 34]$	17.2	0.74	11.1
BRD-Groupe SG	11.4	$[-2, 28]$	15.8	0.64	11.2

- LRMES (%): market fall below -10% in 22 days Brownlees & Engle (2017); 90% range: 5% and 95% quantiles of the bank's loss on the crisis paths; ρ_T: last DCC correlation; Λ^* with $k = 8\%$ from this 22-day LRMES (not comparable with the shortcut Λ^*)

LRMES by Simulation: Thirteen Banks (2/2)

- LRMES is **conditional**: it moves with today's volatility and correlation
  - JPMorgan: 10.6% today, 23.7% with the information of 31 March 2020
  - Deutsche Bank: 14.4% and 25.7%
- The 90% range is wide Brownlees & Engle (2017)
  - LRMES is an average over crisis paths; the shortfall in one particular crisis can be much larger. The range describes scenario dispersion, not uncertainty about the estimated mean
- The scenario, not only the bank, sets the level
  - One-month, -10% crisis: LRMES about a third of the six-month, -40% numbers of Acharya, Engle & Richardson (2012)

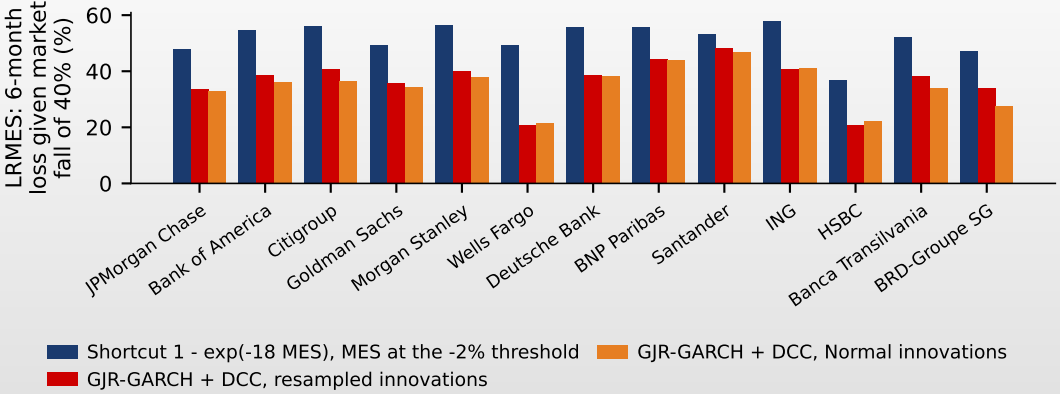
Reading the LRMES Table: Ranges and Scenarios (1/2)

- A negative lower end of the 90% range is not a sign error
  - The loss on each simulated path is minus the bank return; LRMES averages these losses over crisis paths. A negative path loss is a gain: on at least 5% of the crisis paths the bank's shares rise while the market falls
  - This happens when the bank is weakly correlated with its market today, e.g. Wells Fargo: $\rho_T = 0.32$, range $[-8, 24]$

Reading the LRMES Table: Ranges and Scenarios (2/2)

- $\Lambda^* = 1 + (1 - k)(1 - \mathrm{LRMES})/k$ inherits the crisis scenario through LRMES: JPMorgan, $k = 8\%$
  - Shortcut, six months, market -40%: LRMES 48%, $\Lambda^* = 7.0$
  - Simulation, 126 days, market -40%: LRMES 33%, $\Lambda^* = 8.7$
  - Simulation, 22 days, market -10%: LRMES 10.6%, $\Lambda^* = 1 + 0.92(1 - 10.6\%)/0.08 = 11.3$
- A milder crisis gives a smaller LRMES and so a larger Λ^*: compare Λ^* only within one scenario
  - In this chapter the leverage chart and the conclusions table use the shortcut; the LRMES table of thirteen banks uses the 22-day scenario

Model Risk: LRMES under Three Specifications (1/3)



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Model Risk: LRMES under Three Specifications (2/3)

- Six-month crisis, market fall of 40% Acharya, Engle & Richardson (2012); data to 2026-09-18
  - Shortcut $1 - e^{-18\mathrm{MES}^{2\%}}$ vs GJR–GARCH + DCC simulation with resampled or Normal innovations
- Simulated LRMES over the shortcut: 0.42 to 0.90; rank correlation 0.77
  - JPMorgan: 48% (shortcut), 33% (resampled), 33% (Normal)
  - ING: 58%, 41%, 41%

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Model Risk: LRMES under Three Specifications (3/3)

- The shortcut uses the whole history; the simulation starts from today's volatility
- Resampled vs Normal innovations: rank correlation 0.95
  - Levels differ most for Citigroup (40.8% vs 36.3%) and BRD (34.1% vs 27.5%), but the rankings stay almost the same
- Same data, different defensible models, different numbers: model risk Danielsson, James, Valenzuela & Zer (2016)

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How Much Worse Is the System When a Bank Is in Distress?

- MES looks from the market to the bank; **contribution** looks the other way, from the bank to the system
- We need a quantile in the tail of the system, not its mean
  - Quantile regression estimates the conditional quantile directly Koenker & Bassett (1978)
- Levels: $\alpha = 1\%$ and $\alpha = 5\%$, those reported by Adrian & Brunnermeier (2016); we compare the rankings at the two levels
- Questions of this section
  - How much does each bank add to the tail loss of the system?
  - Are the differences between banks statistically significant?

CoVaR: the VaR of the System Given a Bank in Distress (1/2)

- **CoVaR** of the system conditional on bank i at its VaR Adrian & Brunnermeier (2016); X^{sys}, X_i: returns of the system and of bank i
  - $P\left(X^{sys} \leq -\mathrm{CoVaR}_{\alpha}^{sys|i} \,\middle|\, X_i = -\mathrm{VaR}_{i,\alpha}\right) = \alpha$
  - The loss of the system that is exceeded with probability α on a day when bank i is at its own VaR

CoVaR: the VaR of the System Given a Bank in Distress (2/2)

- **ΔCoVaR**: the change from the median state of the bank to its distress state
  - $\Delta\mathrm{CoVaR}_{\alpha}^{sys|i} = \mathrm{CoVaR}_{\alpha}^{sys|X_i=q_\alpha} - \mathrm{CoVaR}_{\alpha}^{sys|X_i=q_{50\%}}$
  - $\mathrm{CoVaR}_{\alpha}^{sys|X_i=q}$: CoVaR with the bank return fixed at its quantile q; $q_{50\%}$: the median, a normal day
- ΔCoVaR measures the **contribution** of bank i to the tail risk of the system
- Reversing the roles gives the **exposure CoVaR**: the VaR of bank i when the system is in distress

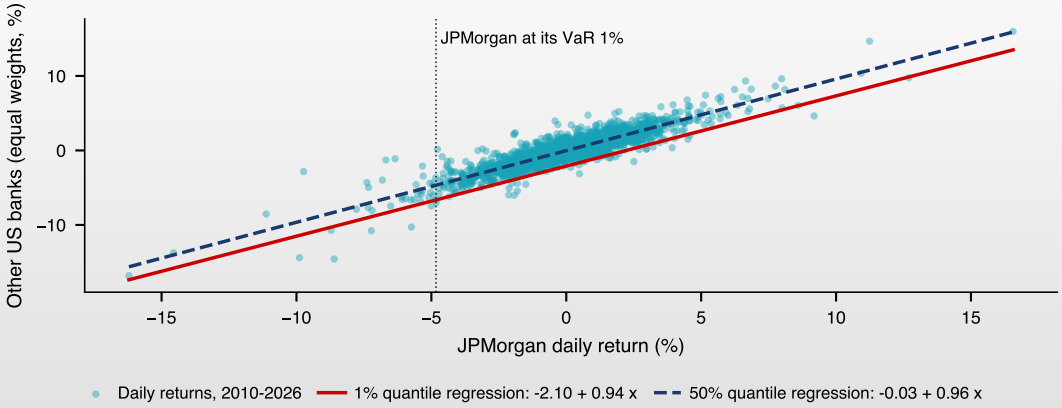
Estimating CoVaR by Quantile Regression (1/2)

- The α-quantile of Y given x is linear: $q_\alpha(Y \mid x) = a_\alpha + b_\alpha x$ Koenker & Bassett (1978)
  - Here Y: the system return, x: the bank return; on the data y_t, x_t: $(\hat{a}_\alpha, \hat{b}_\alpha) = \arg\min_{a,b} \sum_t \rho_\alpha(y_t - a - bx_t)$, $\rho_\alpha(u) = u\,(\alpha - 1\{u < 0\})$
  - ρ_α is the **check function**: it weights negative residuals by $1 - \alpha$ and positive ones by α; $\alpha = 50\%$ gives the median regression
- 1. Quantile regression of the system on the bank at level α
  - $\hat{q}_\alpha(X^{sys} \mid X_i) = \hat{a}_\alpha + \hat{b}_\alpha X_i$
- 2. Plug in the bank's own quantiles: $\hat{q}_\alpha(X_i)$ (distress) and $\hat{q}_{\mathbf{50}\%}(X_i)$ (median)
  - $\mathrm{CoVaR}_\alpha^{sys \mid i} = -\left(\hat{a}_\alpha + \hat{b}_\alpha \hat{q}_\alpha(X_i)\right)$

Estimating CoVaR by Quantile Regression (2/2)

- 3. Take the difference
  - $\Delta\mathrm{CoVaR}_{\alpha}^{sys|i} = \hat{b}_{\alpha}\,(\hat{q}_{\mathbf{50\%}}(X_i) - \hat{q}_{\alpha}(X_i))$
  - Only the slope matters: the intercept cancels
- Uncertainty: moving-block bootstrap with 999 resamples
  - Blocks of consecutive days keep volatility clustering
  - The block length grows like $n^{\mathbf{1/3}}$ Hall, Horowitz & Jing (1995): for $n = 3\,960$, $n^{\mathbf{1/3}} \approx 16$, rounded to 20 days, one trading month

Quantile Regression: JPMorgan and the Other US Banks (1/3)



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Quantile Regression: JPMorgan and the Other US Banks (2/3)

- Daily returns 2010–2026, 1% and 50% quantile regression lines
  - Dotted line: JPMorgan at its VaR 1%
- 1% line: $\hat{q}_{\mathbf{1}1\%} = -2.10 + 0.94\, X_i$; median line: $-0.03 + 0.96\, X_i$
  - Similar slopes: the 1% line is shifted down, not steeper

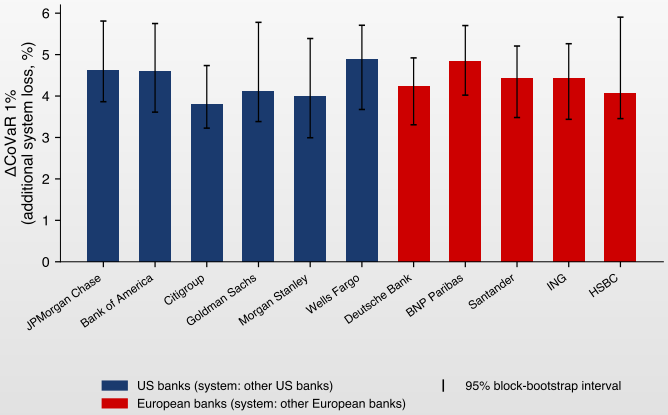
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Quantile Regression: JPMorgan and the Other US Banks (3/3)

- JPMorgan's VaR 1% is 4.83%; the other US banks then have CoVaR 1% = 6.64%
  - Unconditional system VaR 1%: 5.07%; CoVaR 1% with JPMorgan at its median: 2.03%
- $\Delta\mathrm{CoVaR}_{1\%} = 4.62\%$: JPMorgan in distress adds about 4.62 points
  - Association, not causation: a common shock hits all banks on the same day

MFM_ch18_covar

ΔCoVaR 1% of Eleven Banks (1/3)



MFM_ch18_covar

ΔCoVaR 1% of Eleven Banks (2/3)

- System: equal-weighted portfolio of the other banks of the same region
  - Bars: ΔCoVaR, the **extra** system loss when the bank moves from its median to its VaR; 95% moving-block bootstrap intervals
  - No Romanian banks: with only two, the "system" of the other bank would be one single bank, a bilateral link
- From 3.81% (Citigroup) to 4.89% (Wells Fargo); intervals 1.5–2.4 points wide
  - E.g. Citigroup $[3.23, 4.74]$, Wells Fargo $[3.68, 5.71]$: the marginal intervals overlap

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ΔCoVaR 1% of Eleven Banks (3/3)

- Overlap is **not** a test
  - Estimates from the same days are dependent (here strongly positively correlated)
  - The interval for the difference can be narrower than either marginal interval
- At $\alpha = 5\%$ the values are smaller (JPMorgan 2.62%) and the ranking changes
  - Spearman correlation of the 1% and 5% rankings: 0.10; not a robust basis for regulation

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Testing ΔCoVaR 1% (1/2)

- All tests use the same 999 moving-block bootstrap draws of days for every bank, so estimates of different banks keep their dependence (details: Appendix)
- (1) No contribution, H_0: $b_\alpha = 0$: Wald test with the sandwich variance of quantile regression Koenker & Bassett (1978), estimated with a kernel Hendricks & Koenker (1992)
  - Kernel (sandwich) t-ratios of $\hat{b}_{1\%}$ from 4.0 (HSBC) to 6.9 (JPMorgan): every bank contributes (variance formula: Quantile Regression: Asymptotics)
- (2) The tail link equals the central link, H_0: $b_\alpha = b_{50\%}$: is the bank special in crises?
  - Rejected for 2 of 11 banks at 5%: Citigroup and ING, both also after Holm
  - For the other 9 banks the data do not reject equality, which does not prove that the links are equal

Testing ΔCoVaR 1% (2/2)

- (3) Equal contributions, $H_0: \Delta\mathrm{CoVaR}_i = \Delta\mathrm{CoVaR}_j$: the same resampled days for **all** banks give the joint distribution
  - At $\alpha = 1\%$: 4 of 25 within-region pairs differ at the 5% level, 0 after Holm; joint Wald $p = 0.015$ (US), 0.31 (Europe)
  - At $\alpha = 5\%$: 3 of 25 pairs differ at the 5% level, 0 after Holm; joint Wald $p = 0.014$ (US), 0.046 (Europe)
- Significance and dominance tests for systemic importance: Castro & Ferrari (2014); slopes and p-values of every bank:
  ▸ Appendix

Reading the Tests: Holm and the Joint Wald Test (1/2)

- **Many pairs, one family**: with 25 pairs each tested at 5%, more than one false "difference" is expected even if all contributions were equal
  - Holm (1979): sort the m p-values, $p_{(\mathbf{1})} \leq \cdots \leq p_{(m)}$; reject step by step while $p_{(k)} \leq 0.05/(m-k+1)$, stop at the first failure
  - It keeps the probability of **any** false rejection in the family (family-wise error) at most 5%, for any dependence between the tests
  - Toy check, $m = 3$, $p = 0.010, 0.030, 0.040$: $0.010 \leq 0.05/3 = 0.017$ (reject), $0.030 > 0.05/2 = 0.025$ (stop): one rejection instead of three

Reading the Tests: Holm and the Joint Wald Test (2/2)

- **Joint Wald test** of "all contributions in a region are equal": one χ^2 statistic
  - $W = \hat{d}^\top \hat{V}^{-1} \hat{d}$: $\hat{d}$ holds the differences of the other banks from one reference bank (any choice gives the same W), $\hat{V}$ their bootstrap covariance; degrees of freedom: number of banks minus 1
- Why the US joint test rejects ($p = 0.015$) while 0 of 25 pairs remain significant after Holm
  - The joint test pools several moderate differences into one statistic; Holm needs one pair to be very strong on its own ($p_{(1)} \leq 0.05/25$ for the joint family of 15 US and 10 European pairs)
  - Reading: the US contributions are not all equal, but the data do not say which pair differs

Losses at Least Equal to VaR: the Girardi–Ergün CoVaR (1/2)

- Girardi & Ergün (2013) condition on the bank's loss being **at least** its VaR, not exactly equal to it
  - $P\left(X^{sys} \leq -\mathrm{CoVaR}_{\alpha}^{\leq} \,\middle|\, X_i \leq -\mathrm{VaR}_{i,\alpha}\right) = \alpha \iff P\left(X^{sys} \leq -\mathrm{CoVaR}_{\alpha}^{\leq}, X_i \leq -\mathrm{VaR}_{i,\alpha}\right) = \alpha^2$
  - $\mathrm{CoVaR}_{\alpha}^{\leq}$: CoVaR given a loss at least as large as the VaR; the joint form follows from $P(A \mid B) = P(A,B)/P(B)$ with $P(B) = \alpha$
  - Benchmark state: a one-standard-deviation event $|X_i - \mu_i| \leq \sigma_i$ (μ_i, σ_i: mean and standard deviation of X_i) instead of the median; it enters only $\Delta\mathrm{CoVaR}^{\leq}$, while the numbers below compare CoVaR levels

Losses at Least Equal to VaR: the Girardi–Ergün CoVaR (2/2)

- Why it matters
  - It includes more severe distress than the VaR day itself, and it rises with the strength of dependence (e.g. with the correlation ρ of a bivariate Normal), which the CoVaR given $X_i = -\mathrm{VaR}_{i,\alpha}$ need not do Mainik & Schaanning (2014)
  - It can be **backtested**: the joint hit $\{X^{sys} \leq -\mathrm{CoVaR}^{\leq}, X_i \leq -\mathrm{VaR}_i\}$ has probability α^2
- Historical estimate at $\alpha = 5\%$: the 5% quantile of the system on the 198 days with $X_i \leq \hat{q}_{5\%}(X_i)$
  - JPMorgan: $\mathrm{CoVaR}^{\leq}_{5\%} = 7.70\%$ vs the quantile-regression $\mathrm{CoVaR}_{5\%} = 3.81\%$; eleven banks: 7.3–8.2% vs 3.6–4.8%
  - About twice as large in our data: the whole tail of the bank is a harsher conditioning event; under the Normal distribution this change raises CoVaR only modestly, so the factor of two is consistent with departures from the Normal benchmark; this ratio alone does not identify their cause

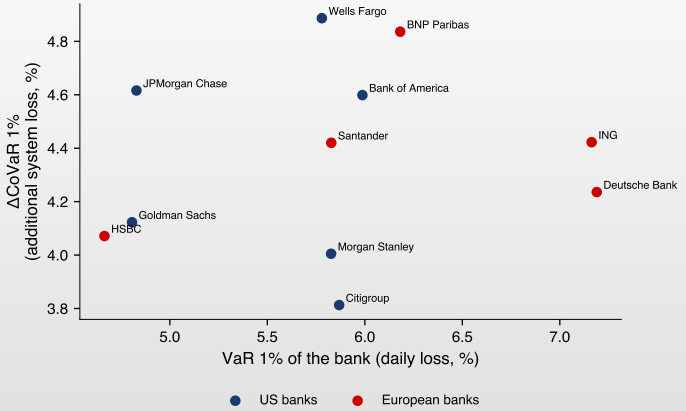
A Normal Check: Which CoVaR Rises with Dependence? (1/2)

- Bivariate Normal with zero means, $\sigma_{sys} = 1.5$, $\alpha = 1\%$, $z = -2.326$; the bank sits at its VaR, $X_i = -\mathrm{VaR}_{i,\alpha}$
  - Given the bank, the system has mean $\rho\,\sigma_{sys} z$ and standard deviation $\sigma_{sys}\sqrt{1-\rho^2}$
  - Hence $\mathrm{CoVaR}_\alpha = \sigma_{sys}|z|\left(\rho + \sqrt{1-\rho^2}\right)$ and, with the median state $X_i = 0$, $\Delta\mathrm{CoVaR}_\alpha = \rho\,\sigma_{sys}|z|$

A Normal Check: Which CoVaR Rises with Dependence? (2/2)

- Toy check: strengthen the link from $\rho = 0.6$ to $\rho = 0.9$
  - $\mathrm{CoVaR}_{1\%}$: 4.89% falls to 4.66%, because $\rho + \sqrt{1-\rho^2}$ peaks at $\rho = 0.71$
  - $\Delta\mathrm{CoVaR}_{1\%}$: 2.09% rises to 3.14%
- Lesson: a CoVaR level conditioned on $X_i = -\mathrm{VaR}_{i,\alpha}$ can fall when banks become more interdependent
  - In this model the difference ΔCoVaR rises with ρ (formula above), and so does the Girardi–Ergün $\mathrm{CoVaR}^{\leq}$ Mainik & Schaanning (2014)

VaR and ΔCoVaR Measure Different Things (1/2)



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VaR and ΔCoVaR Measure Different Things (2/2)

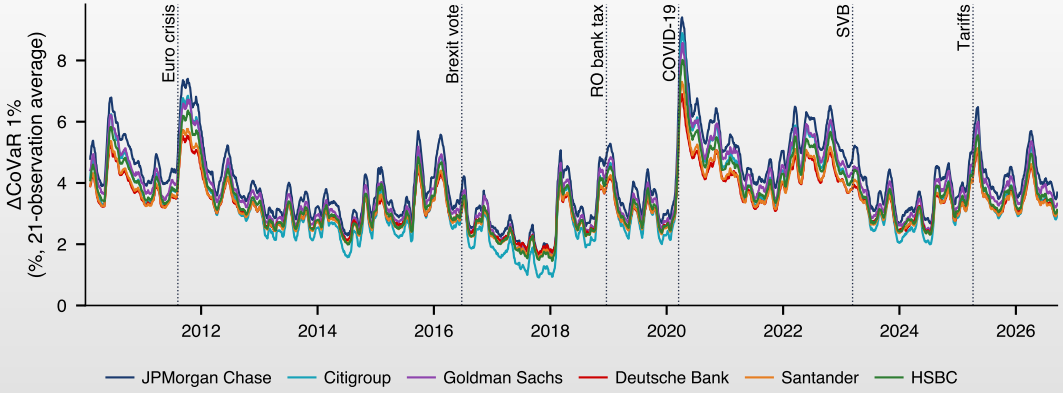
- Horizontal: VaR 1% of the bank; vertical: its ΔCoVaR 1%; eleven banks, 2010–2026
- Spearman rank correlation between VaR and ΔCoVaR: 0.16
  - Deutsche Bank and ING: the largest VaR (7.19%, 7.16%), only average ΔCoVaR
  - JPMorgan: one of the smallest VaR (4.83%), one of the largest ΔCoVaR
- Central message of Adrian & Brunnermeier (2016)
  - Regulating each bank by its own VaR ignores its contribution to the system
- Caveat: with eleven banks and overlapping intervals the correlation is very uncertain

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ΔCoVaR 1% over Time: State Variables

- The question: does the contribution of a bank rise in stress periods?
- The quantiles of the bank depend on state variables M_{t-1} Adrian & Brunnermeier (2016)
  - M_{t-1}: log VIX, regional index return and system return, all lagged one day
  - $\Delta\mathrm{CoVaR}_{\alpha,t} = \hat{b}\left(\hat{q}_{50\%,t}(X_i) - \hat{q}_{\alpha,t}(X_i)\right)$, with $\hat{q}_{\cdot,t}$ conditional on M_{t-1} (Appendix)
- The slope $\hat{b}$ stays constant: ΔCoVaR moves with the conditional VaR of the bank

ΔCoVaR 1% over Time (1/2)



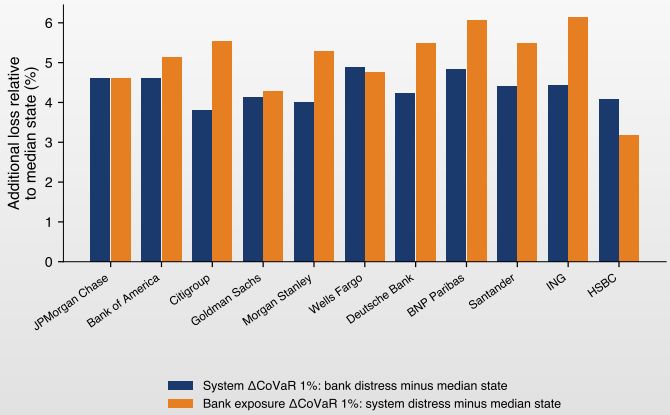
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ΔCoVaR 1% over Time (2/2)

- Six banks, moving averages over 21 observations of the daily ΔCoVaR 1%
- JPMorgan: mean 2.16% in 2017, mean 9.06% in March 2020; peak 10.99% on 2020-03-18
  - Deutsche Bank: mean 2.04% in 2017, mean 6.65% in March 2020
- Low in calm periods, exactly when risk may build up in balance sheets
  - Hence Adrian & Brunnermeier (2016) propose a forward ΔCoVaR, predicted from leverage, size and maturity mismatch (long-term assets funded by short-term debt, which must be rolled over)

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Contribution versus Exposure (1/3)



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Contribution versus Exposure (2/3)

- Two directions of ΔCoVaR 1%
  - Blue, contribution: loss of the system when the bank is in distress
  - Orange, exposure: loss of the bank when the system is in distress; same plug-in with the roles swapped (X_i regressed on X^{sys}, quantiles of X^{sys} plugged in)

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Contribution versus Exposure (3/3)

- The direction matters: the two numbers differ for most banks
  - ING: contribution 4.42%, exposure 6.14%; BNP Paribas: 4.84% and 6.07%
  - HSBC: contribution 4.07%, exposure only 3.17%
- Exposure exceeds contribution for most European banks
  - Both are associations, not causal effects
- Exposure matters for the bank's own capital; contribution for the regulator

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How Much Can We Trust a Ranking? (1/2)

- Rankings by different systemic measures disagree Nucera, Schwaab, Koopman & Lucas (2016)
  - Each ranking has wide sampling uncertainty
  - Combine measures and report rank uncertainty instead of a single ordering
- Model risk: the same bank's measure varies across estimation methods Danielsson, James, Valenzuela & Zer (2016)
  - Examples in this chapter: simulated vs shortcut LRMES, Girardi–Ergün vs quantile-regression CoVaR, rankings at $\alpha = 1\%$ vs 5%

How Much Can We Trust a Ranking? (2/2)

- Effective tail sample αn: 40 days at 1%, 198 at 5%, out of 3 960
  - At 1% the kernel and block-bootstrap standard errors disagree (Appendix)
- Out-of-sample backtests of $\mathrm{CoVaR}^{\leq}_{5\%}$ reject for no bank (Appendix)
  - With about 7.4 expected joint hits their power is low
- What survives: large, tested differences
  - Regions and the tail slope of some banks, not the order of eleven close point estimates

Through Which Links Do Shocks Travel between Banks?

- MES and CoVaR look at one bank and one aggregate; a crisis, however, travels between many banks at once
- A network answers three questions
  - Who transmits shocks and who receives them?
  - How connected is the system as a whole?
  - Does connectedness rise in crises?
- The approach: the forecast-error variance decomposition of a VAR Diebold & Yilmaz (2014), on the daily volatilities of the banks

From Pairs to Networks: the Variance Decomposition (1/2)

- A **network** looks at all pairs of banks at once
  - Nodes: banks; directed edges: how much of the future uncertainty of bank i comes from shocks to bank j
- Vector autoregression (VAR) of order p for N series y_t: $y_t = c + \sum_{l=1}^{p} A_l\, y_{t-l} + \varepsilon_t$, $\mathrm{Cov}(\varepsilon_t) = \Sigma$
  - Each series is regressed on p lags of all series: c: constants; A_l: $N \times N$ coefficient matrices; ε_t: shocks; Σ: their covariance matrix (assumptions: Appendix)
- Variance-decomposition networks Diebold & Yilmaz (2009), Diebold & Yilmaz (2012), Diebold & Yilmaz (2014): the approach of this section
- Other networks: Granger causality Billio, Getmansky, Lo & Pelizzon (2012) (Appendix), tail networks TENET (Tail-Event driven NETwork risk) Härdle, Wang & Yu (2016) and the Financial Risk Meter (next section)

From Pairs to Networks: the Variance Decomposition (2/2)

- The H-day forecast error of y_i is a sum of shocks to all series: its variance can be split by source
  - Moving-average form $y_t = \mu + \sum_{h \geq \mathbf{0}} \Phi_h \varepsilon_{t-h}$: Φ_h is the response of y after h days to a shock today, $\Phi_{\mathbf{0}} = I$
- Orthogonal (Cholesky) shocks depend on the ordering of the series; the **generalized** decomposition does not Koop, Pesaran & Potter (1996), Pesaran & Shin (1998)
  - $\theta_{ij}(H) = \dfrac{\sigma_{jj}^{-\mathbf{1}} \sum_{h=\mathbf{0}}^{H-\mathbf{1}} (e_i^\top \Phi_h \Sigma e_j)^{\mathbf{2}}}{\sum_{h=\mathbf{0}}^{H-\mathbf{1}} e_i^\top \Phi_h \Sigma \Phi_h^\top e_i}$, normalised: $\tilde{\theta}_{ij} = \theta_{ij} / \sum_j \theta_{ij}$
  - Numerator: the part of the forecast error variance of i due to a shock in j; denominator: the total forecast error variance of i
  - e_i: the i-th unit vector (it picks series i); σ_{jj}: the variance of shock j, the j-th diagonal element of Σ

The Connectedness Table (1/2)

- $\tilde{\theta}_{ij}$ (in %): the share of the H-day forecast error variance of i due to shocks in j Diebold & Yilmaz (2014)
  - Each row sums to 100
  - Before normalisation rows of θ_{ij} do not sum to one: generalized shocks are correlated

The Connectedness Table (2/2)

- Directional measures
  - **From** others: $F_i = \sum_{j \neq i} \tilde{\theta}_{ij}$; **to** others: $T_j = \sum_{i \neq j} \tilde{\theta}_{ij}$
  - **Net**: $T_i - F_i$, positive for a net transmitter
  - **Pairwise net**: $\tilde{\theta}_{ji} - \tilde{\theta}_{ij} > 0$ means i transmits net to j, drawn as an arrow $i \to j$
- **Total connectedness**: $C = \frac{1}{N} \sum_{i \neq j} \tilde{\theta}_{ij}$
  - The average share of variance that comes from the others, between 0 and 100%

Example: the Connectedness Table for Two Banks

Bank $i \setminus$ shock j	1	2	F_i
1	80	20	20
2	40	60	40
T_j	40	20	

- Toy normalised table $\tilde{\theta}_{ij}$ (%): row i is the bank whose variance is split, column j the source of the shock; rows sum to 100
- Off-diagonal cells only
  - From others: $F_{\mathbf{1}} = 20$, $F_{\mathbf{2}} = 40$ (row sums)
  - To others: $T_{\mathbf{1}} = 40$, $T_{\mathbf{2}} = 20$ (column sums)
- Net: bank 1 $40 - 20 = +20$ (transmitter), bank 2 -20; net positions always sum to zero
- Total: $C = (20 + 40)/2 = 30\%$

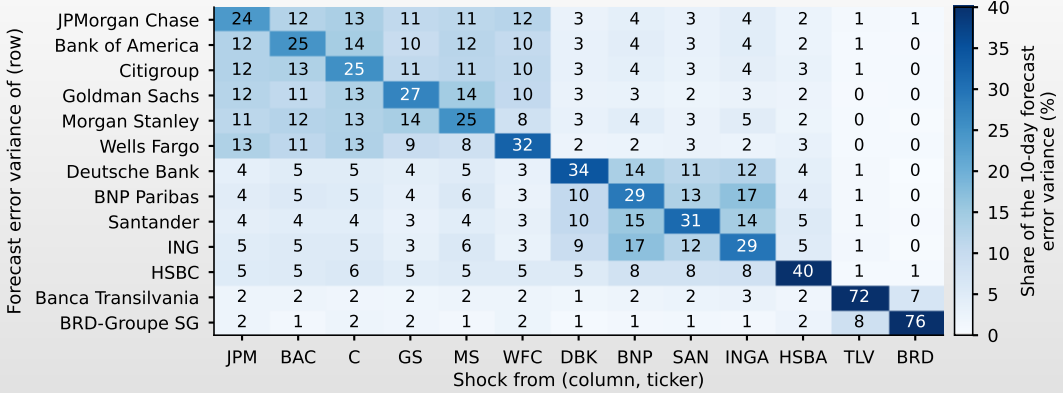
Parkinson Range Volatility and the VAR of the Thirteen Banks (1/2)

- **Parkinson volatility** from the daily high price $P_t^{\max}$ and low price $P_t^{\min}$ Parkinson (1980)
  - $\hat{\sigma}_t^2 = \dfrac{(\ln P_t^{\max} - \ln P_t^{\min})^2}{4 \ln 2}$, annualised $100\sqrt{252\,\hat{\sigma}_t^2}$, used in logs
  - Unbiased for the variance of a Brownian motion without drift; more efficient than the squared return

Parkinson Range Volatility and the VAR of the Thirteen Banks (2/2)

- Our model: VAR on the log volatility of the 13 banks
  - Volatility, not returns: it jumps in crises, so its network shows where stress travels; a range-based volatility, as in Demirer et al. (2018)
  - Order by the Bayesian information criterion (BIC, which penalises the number of parameters): $p = 2$
  - Forecast horizon $H = 10$ days, as in Diebold & Yilmaz (2012)
  - Time zones: US banks close after European ones; the VAR lags capture next-day transmission

The Connectedness Table of Thirteen Banks (1/3)



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The Connectedness Table of Thirteen Banks (2/3)

- Row i, column j: share (%) of the 10-day forecast error variance of bank i due to shocks in bank j
  - Full sample; the columns use the tickers of the data table (e.g. INGA = ING, HSBA = HSBC)
- Total connectedness $C = 63.9\%$
  - On average two thirds of a bank's volatility risk comes from the other banks
  - On returns instead of volatility: $C = 75.4\%$

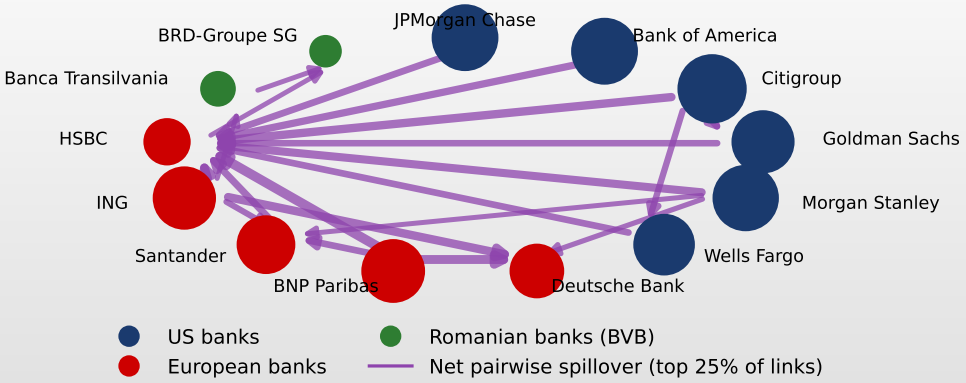
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The Connectedness Table of Thirteen Banks (3/3)

- Two regional blocks, own shock included
  - A US bank receives 84.0% from US shocks, a European bank 72.7% from European shocks
  - Across the Atlantic: 26.2% from US to a European bank, 15.0% the other way
- Romanian banks: mostly their own shocks
  - Own share 72.3% (Banca Transilvania), 76.1% (BRD); from US banks 10.3%, from European banks 8.0%

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The Net Spillover Network (1/3)



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The Net Spillover Network (2/3)

- Arrow $j \to i$ when j transmits net to i (largest 25% of pairwise net spillovers)
  - Node size grows with the spillover to others
- Net transmitters: Citigroup (+19.0), Bank of America (+10.9), Morgan Stanley (+9.9), JPMorgan (+9.8)
  - To others: Citigroup 93.8%, JPMorgan 86.2% (a column sum can exceed 100)

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The Net Spillover Network (3/3)

- Net receivers: HSBC (-23.6), BRD (-13.0), Deutsche Bank (-12.6), Banca Transilvania (-12.2)
  - HSBC receives from almost every bank: it trades in London, between Asia and New York
- Within Europe, BNP Paribas and ING transmit to Deutsche Bank and Santander
- A full-sample network averages quiet and crisis years

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Connectedness over Time (1/3)



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Connectedness over Time (2/3)

- Top: total connectedness on moving 250-day windows, about one trading year (VAR(2), $H = 10$, every 5 days); bottom: net spillover summed by region
- The total index ranges from 47.4% (2024-07-24) to 79.3% (2020-08-27); mean 62.0%
  - COVID-19: from 61.8% in 2019 to 78.4% in spring 2020
  - The index rises within days; its fall about 250 days later partly reflects the crisis leaving the window
  - After the 2023 bank failures 66.0%; the calm year 2024 53.5%

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Connectedness over Time (3/3)

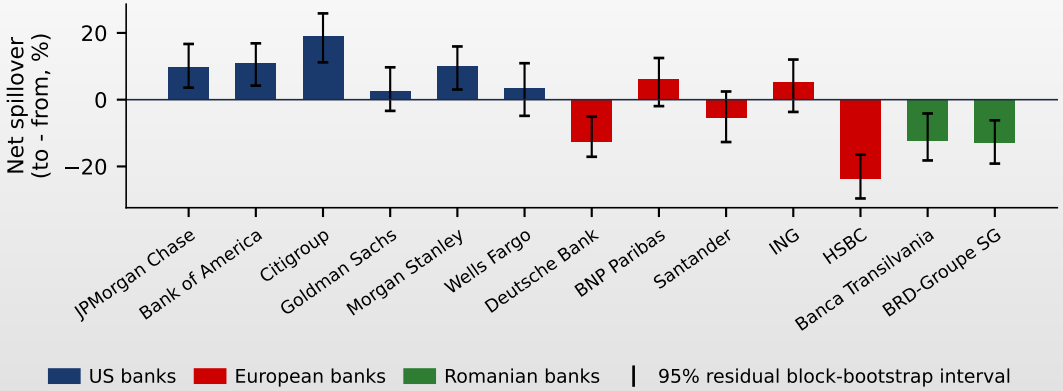
- US banks are net transmitters in 89% of the windows (sum of the net spillovers of the six US banks, averaged over windows: $+48.4$ points)
  - European banks were net transmitters during the euro crisis of 2011–2012 and mostly net receivers afterwards
- Romanian banks are net receivers on average (sum of the net spillovers of the two Romanian banks, averaged over windows: -24.1 points)

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Estimation Error: How Reliable Is the Network?

- The question: which "transmitter" and "receiver" labels survive estimation error?
- A VAR(1) on 13 series has 169 slope coefficients; the VAR(2) used here has $2 \times 169 = 338$
  - A 250-day window: 250 observations per equation for 26 slopes and a constant; the table is a nonlinear function of all of them
- Residual block bootstrap, 999 draws
  - Resample 20-day blocks of residual vectors, rebuild the series with the estimated VAR, re-estimate, recompute the table

Estimation Error: Bootstrap Intervals for the Network (1/2)



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Estimation Error: Bootstrap Intervals for the Network (2/2)

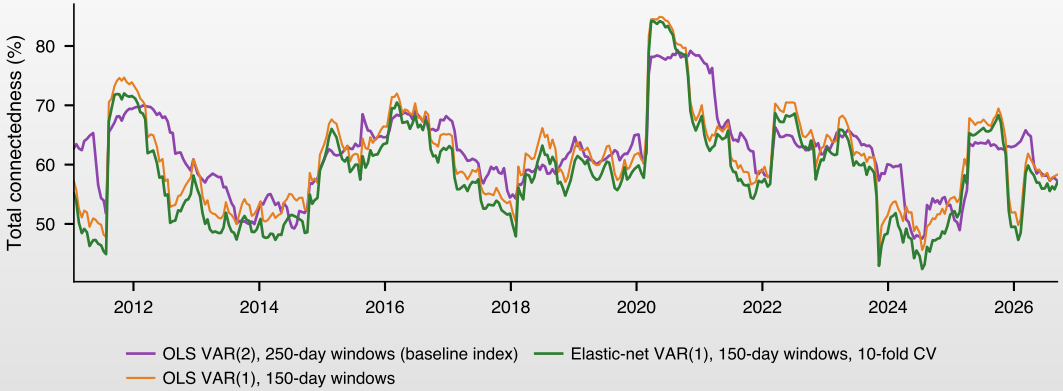
- Full sample, $p = 2$: $C = 63.9\%$, 95% interval $[59.9, 65.8]$
  - Peak window (to 2020-08-27): $C = 79.3\%$, $[65.9, 83.0]$; bootstrap mean 75.8%: small samples also bias C
- 8 of 13 net positions have intervals that exclude zero
  - For the other 5 the label "transmitter" or "receiver" is not identified
  - The net spillover network draws the largest 25% of links, some of them not significant: hence the intervals

MFM_ch18_spillover_uncertainty

Elastic-Net Connectedness: Does the Network Depend on the Estimator?

- A VAR(2) on 13 series has 338 slopes: in short windows OLS overfits
- Demirer et al. (2018): each VAR equation by the adaptive elastic net; in the 150-day windows, the plain elastic net
  - λ chosen equation by equation by 10-fold cross-validation, "10-fold CV" in the chart (definition in the Appendix)
- We compare, on the same window end dates, the base index with indices on 150-day windows

OLS and Elastic-Net Connectedness in Rolling Windows (1/2)



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OLS and Elastic-Net Connectedness in Rolling Windows (2/2)

- Full sample: $C = 63.3\%$ (OLS, ordinary least squares: 63.9%); 59% of coefficients non-zero
- Means over 372 common window end dates, moving by 10 trading days; baseline recomputed on those same dates
  - Baseline (OLS VAR(2), 250 days) 62.0%; OLS VAR(1), 150 days 61.1%; elastic-net VAR(1), 150 days 58.7%
- The dynamics agree: correlation 0.82 between the elastic-net and the base index; crisis peaks in the same weeks
  - Levels depend on window, estimator and lag order; changes over time are robust

MFM_ch18_spillover_uncertainty

How Tight Are the Links between Banks in the Tail?

- The spillover network describes an average shock, while systemic risk sits in the tail
- Financial Risk Meter (FRM) Mihoci, Althof, Chen & Härdle (2020): for each bank, a tail quantile regression on all other banks
  - Too many regressors for a short window: the LASSO penalty keeps only the strong links
  - The indicator is the average selected penalty across banks
- The question of this section: does this indicator track systemic stress on our 13 banks too?

The Financial Risk Meter and the GACV Penalty (1/3)

- For each firm j, a quantile regression at $\tau = 5\%$ of its return on the returns of **all** other firms and on lagged macro variables Mihoci, Althof, Chen & Härdle (2020)
  - With 100 firms and a 63-day window there are more regressors than days: a penalty is needed

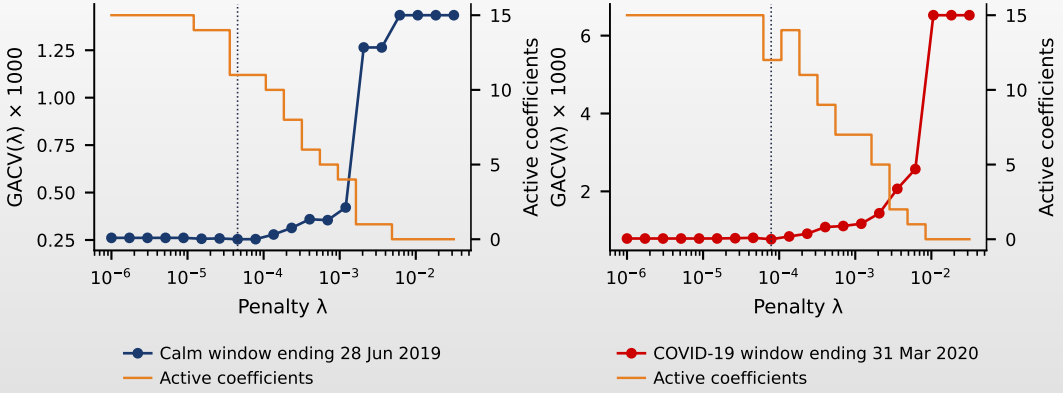
The Financial Risk Meter and the GACV Penalty (2/3)

- **LASSO** (Least Absolute Shrinkage and Selection Operator) quantile regression Belloni & Chernozhukov (2011)
  - $\hat{\beta}_j(\lambda) = \arg\min_\beta \frac{1}{n} \sum_t \rho_\tau \left(X_{j,t} - \beta_{\mathbf{0}} - \beta^\top Z_{-j,t} \right) + \lambda \|\beta\|_{\mathbf{1}}$
  - $X_{j,t}$: return of firm j; $Z_{-j,t}$: returns of the other firms and the lagged macro variables; $\beta_{\mathbf{0}}$: intercept; ρ_τ: the check function; $\|\beta\|_{\mathbf{1}} = \sum_k |\beta_k|$; n: days in the window
  - λ switches off weak links: a larger λ leaves fewer active coefficients
- **GACV** (Generalized Approximate Cross-Validation) trades fit against the number of active coefficients
  - $\mathrm{GACV}(\lambda) = \frac{\sum_t \rho_\tau \left(X_{j,t} - \hat{X}_{j,t}(\lambda) \right)}{n - \mathrm{df}(\lambda)}$, $\hat{X}_{j,t}(\lambda)$: fitted quantile; df = number of nonzero coefficients; the selected λ_j minimises GACV

The Financial Risk Meter and the GACV Penalty (3/3)

- The **FRM** (Financial Risk Meter) is the average of the selected λ_j over firms, designed as an indicator of tail interdependence and systemic stress
  - Built for US financial firms Mihoci, Althof, Chen & Härdle (2020), emerging markets Ben Amor, Althof & Härdle (2022) and China Wang, Althof & Härdle (2023)
- Our version: 13 banks, macro variables S&P 500, Euro Stoxx 50 and VIX at $t-1$, 63-day windows every 10 days
  - $\tau = 5\%$ and 63-day windows, about one trading quarter, are those of Mihoci, Althof, Chen & Härdle (2020)
  - 15 regressors for 63 days: far fewer than in the published FRM
- Extensions: FRM based on expectiles Ren, Lu, Li & Härdle (2022), for cryptocurrencies Ren, Althof & Härdle (2025) and for the EU energy sector Toma, Dima, Grecu, Pele & Lessmann (2026)

GACV in a Calm and in a Crisis Window (1/2)



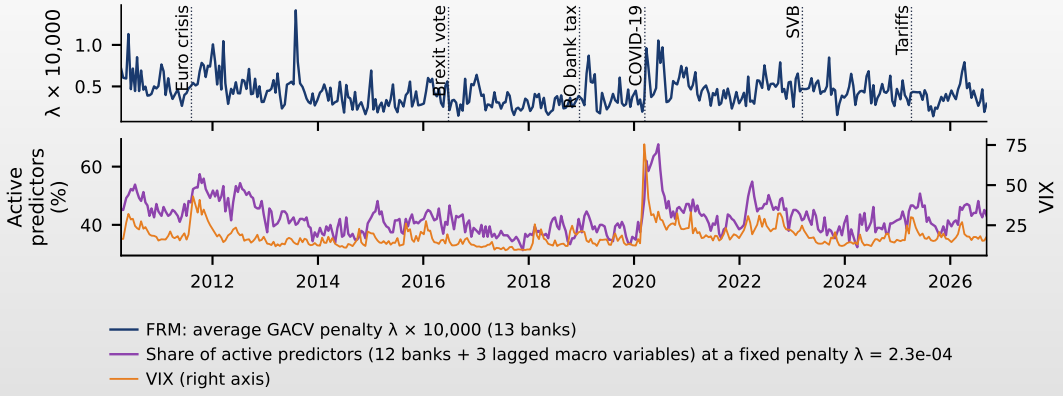
MFM_ch18_frm

GACV in a Calm and in a Crisis Window (2/2)

- JPMorgan on the other 12 banks and three lagged macro variables, 63 days
  - Dotted line: selected λ; orange: active coefficients
- Calm window (to 28 June 2019): $\hat{\lambda} = 4.5 \times 10^{-5}$, 11 of 15 coefficients active
  - COVID-19 window (to 31 March 2020): $\hat{\lambda} = 7.8 \times 10^{-5}$, 12 active
- In the crisis the whole GACV curve is about three times higher
  - The check loss is in return units, and crisis returns are larger
- With few regressors the minimum lies at almost no penalty: the selection is noisy

MFM_ch18_frm

The Financial Risk Meter of Thirteen Banks (1/2)



MFM_ch18_frm

The Financial Risk Meter of Thirteen Banks (2/2)

- Top: average GACV penalty over 13 banks; 390 windows of 63 days
  - Bottom: share of active predictors at a fixed λ, with the VIX
- The average GACV penalty is noisy: correlation with the VIX only 0.35
- At a fixed $\lambda = 2.3 \times 10^{-4}$ the share of active predictors follows the VIX more closely (0.62)
  - From 31% (2017-11-21) to 68% (2020-06-17); average 42%
- Lesson: on this small panel, neither measure is shown to be a reliable systemic-risk indicator
  - The fixed-penalty count is only an exploratory sensitivity check

MFM_ch18_frm

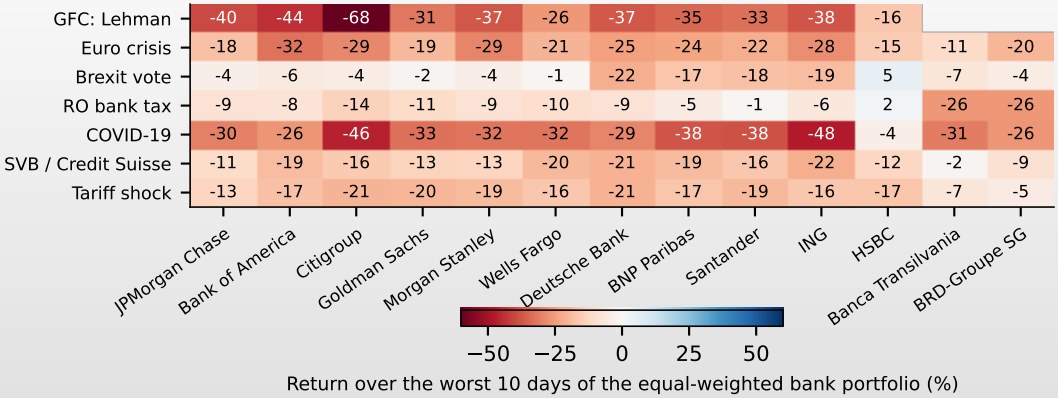
How Much Would We Lose in a Severe but Plausible Scenario? (1/2)

- A **stress test** applies a severe but plausible scenario to the banks and measures the loss
  - **Historical**: replay a past crisis; **hypothetical**: shock chosen factors
  - **Reverse**: find the most plausible scenario behind a given loss (e.g. one that would make the bank non-viable)
  - Supervisory tests: Federal Reserve stress tests (US), European Banking Authority (EU)
  - Global systemically important banks: a regulatory list, scored by the Basel Committee on size, interconnectedness, substitutability, complexity and cross-border activity; they hold extra capital Basel Committee (2018)

How Much Would We Lose in a Severe but Plausible Scenario? (2/2)

- Seven episodes, each a window of a few weeks around a known shock
  - Lehman (autumn 2008; "GFC" in the chart: global financial crisis), euro crisis (summer 2011), Brexit vote (June 2016), Romanian bank tax (December 2018)
  - COVID-19 (March 2020), SVB and Credit Suisse (March 2023), the tariff shock (April 2025)
- In each window: the **10 consecutive trading days with the lowest cumulative return** of the equal-weighted bank portfolio
  - We report every bank's return over that interval; ten days match the market-risk horizon (Chapter 7)
  - 2008 uses the 11 international banks only: the Romanian series start in 2010

Seven Historical Stress Scenarios (1/3)



MFM_ch18_stress

Seven Historical Stress Scenarios (2/3)

- Simple return (%) of each bank over the worst 10 consecutive days of the bank portfolio in each episode, $100(e^{\sum_t r_t/\mathbf{100}} - 1)$ from the 10 daily log returns r_t; blank: no data
- Portfolio loss over the worst 10 days
  - Lehman 37.6% (2008-11-10 – 2008-11-21), COVID-19 31.9%, euro crisis 22.3%
  - Tariffs 16.0%, SVB 14.8%, Romanian bank tax 10.2%, Brexit 7.9%
- Worst single cells: Citigroup −68% in 2008, ING −48% in March 2020
  - All numbers here are simple returns, i.e. price changes; Citigroup's −68% is −114% as a cumulative log return, which is not bounded by −100%

Seven Historical Stress Scenarios (3/3)

- Shocks are local as well as global
  - Brexit hit mainly European banks
  - The Romanian bank tax hit Romanian banks hardest (-26%, -26%)
  - In the same December 2018 window, US banks lost between 8% and 14%
- A stress test built only on global crises would miss the domestic political shock

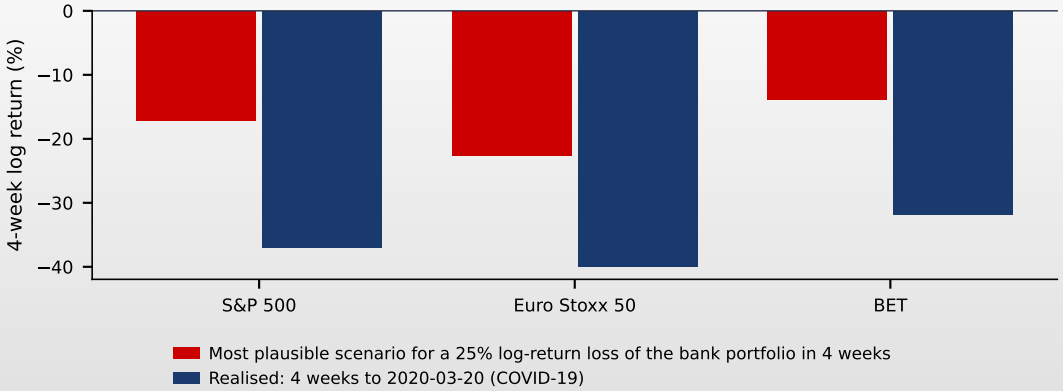
Reverse Stress Testing (1/2)

- Factor model of weekly bank log returns (%): $X_i = \beta_i^\top f + e_i$
  - Factors f = (S&P 500, Euro Stoxx 50, BET); β_i: the bank's factor betas; e_i: idiosyncratic return
  - Over h weeks $f \sim N(0, h\Sigma)$, Σ: weekly factor covariance (no serial covariance assumed)

Reverse Stress Testing (2/2)

- Portfolio loss $L = -b^\top f$, b: the average of the β_i
  - Equal-weighted portfolio of the 13 banks, $w_i = 1/13$; L is a log-return loss in %
  - A factor-only approximation: the residual $\sum_i w_i e_i$ is set to zero
- Most plausible scenario with loss ℓ^*: minimise $f^\top (h\Sigma)^{-\mathbf{1}} f$ subject to $-b^\top f = \ell^*$
  - $f^* = -\ell^* \dfrac{h\Sigma\, b}{b^\top h\Sigma\, b}, \qquad d^* = \dfrac{\ell^*}{\sqrt{b^\top h\Sigma\, b}}$
  - $f^\top (h\Sigma)^{-\mathbf{1}} f$: the squared Mahalanobis distance; d^*: portfolio standard deviations; larger means less plausible (two-factor example: ▸ Appendix)

The Most Plausible Scenario for a 25% Log-Return Loss (1/3)



MFM_ch18_stress

The Most Plausible Scenario for a 25% Log-Return Loss (2/3)

- Weekly data 2010–2026 (871 weeks), four-week horizon, the length of the acute phase of March 2020
  - Red: f^* for $\ell^* = 25\%$; blue: factor moves in the worst four weeks of 2020
- Portfolio betas $b = (0.45, 0.65, 0.18)$; four-week standard deviation of the portfolio 5.79%
  - A 25% log loss (arithmetic 22.1%) needs S&P 500 -17.2%, Euro Stoxx 50 -22.6%, BET -13.9% together

MFM_ch18_stress

The Most Plausible Scenario for a 25% Log-Return Loss (3/3)

- $d^* = 4.31$: Normal probability 8.0×10^{-6} per four weeks
  - Yet in the four weeks to 2020-03-20 the portfolio had a log loss of 52.0% (model: 48.5%)
- The shape of the scenario is informative; its probability is not
  - Heavy tails and rising correlations make Normal probabilities far too small

MFM_ch18_stress

Climate Risk: Physical and Transition Risk



Seat of the European Central Bank, Frankfurt, 2015

Photo: DXR (2015); CC BY-SA 4.0; Wikimedia Commons

- **Physical risk**: losses from floods, droughts, heat and storms that damage collateral and borrowers
- **Transition risk**: losses from the move to a low-carbon economy (carbon prices, regulation, technology)
- "Green swan" risks: potentially extremely disruptive events that could be behind the next systemic financial crisis; backward-looking risk models cannot anticipate them Bolton et al. (2020)

The ECB Climate Stress Test of 2022: Results

- 104 significant banks took part in the ECB test of 2022; a bottom-up projection of losses (each bank runs the supervisor's scenarios on its own data and models) covered 41 of them ECB Banking Supervision (2022)
- About 60% of banks had no climate risk stress-testing framework; only 20% considered climate risk when granting loans
- Credit and market losses of around EUR 70 billion for the 41 banks, under a short-term disorderly transition and two physical risk scenarios
  - The ECB states that this significantly understates the risk: data gaps, rudimentary models, no second-round effects

Limits of Stress Tests

- Scenarios are chosen by people: the crisis that comes is rarely the one that was tested
- Second-round effects (fire sales, funding runs, counterparty losses) are hard to model and usually left out, as the ECB noted for its climate test
- Market-based measures (MES, CoVaR, connectedness) react quickly but only after prices move; balance-sheet stress tests look forward but slowly
- Early-warning research combines market measures with balance-sheet data

Does the Network Change with the Size of Shocks?

- Ando, Greenwood-Nimmo & Shin (2022) ask whether the topology of a financial network changes with the **size** of the shocks that hit it
  - Their version of the question of Diebold & Yilmaz (2014): how much of the future uncertainty of i is due to idiosyncratic shocks from j, as the shock size varies?
- Why it matters: the connectedness of this chapter is estimated at the conditional mean (OLS, LASSO, elastic net Demirer et al. (2018)), i.e. it describes how an average shock spreads
  - Systemic shocks are larger than average; reading a rise in rolling connectedness as a crisis signal assumes that mean relations also hold in the tails
- Link to this chapter: the quantile regression of CoVaR Adrian & Brunnermeier (2016), Koenker & Bassett (1978), now inside the VAR and its variance decomposition
  - Giglio, Kelly & Pruitt (2016) showed that systemic risk shifts the lower tail of future output more than its centre; Ando, Greenwood-Nimmo & Shin (2022) ask the same tail-versus-centre question of the network itself
- Application: the credit risk loop between sovereigns and their banks, in which bailouts move bank risk onto the state

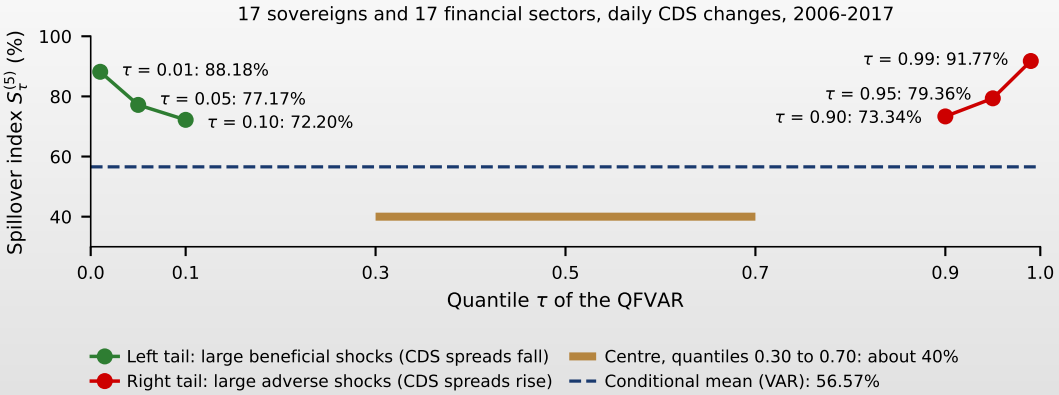
CDS Data and the Factor Quantile VAR

- CDS (credit default swap) spread: the annual premium, in basis points of the insured amount (1 bp $= 0.01\%$), paid for protection against the default of a sovereign or bank; it rises when default risk rises, so an increase is bad news
- Data: daily first differences of 5-year CDS spreads (basis points) of 17 sovereigns and 17 national financial sectors, $m = 34$, 3 January 2006 – 29 December 2017, 3 129 days
- Quantile factor VAR (QFVAR): $y_t = \mu + \sum_{j=1}^{p} \Phi_j y_{t-j} + \Gamma f_t + v_t$, each equation fitted at quantile τ by minimising the check loss
  - y_t: the m CDS changes; μ: constants; Φ_j: VAR coefficient matrices; Γ: factor loadings
  - Unobserved factors f_t absorb common shocks, so v_t is idiosyncratic; their number by the criterion of Ando & Bai (2020): 10 at the mean

Spillovers and Adverse Credit Shocks

- Generalized forecast error variance decomposition (FEVD) of the idiosyncratic shocks at quantile τ, rows normalised to 1; spillover index $S_\tau^{(h)} = m^{-1} \sum_i F_{i\leftarrow\bullet,\tau}^{(h)}$
  - $F_{i\leftarrow\bullet,\tau}^{(h)}$: the share of the h-day forecast error variance of i that comes from the others, the "from" of the connectedness table; $S_\tau^{(h)}$ is its average over the m series
- Rolling windows of $w = 250$ days (2 880 windows), number of factors fixed at its full-sample value (full specification: ▸ Appendix); relative tail dependence $\mathrm{RTD} = S_{0.95}^{(5)} - S_{0.05}^{(5)}$
  - For CDS changes the right tail ($\tau = 0.95$) holds large adverse shocks, the left tail ($\tau = 0.05$) large beneficial ones

Spillovers across Quantiles (1/3)



MFM_ch18_quantile_connectedness

Spillovers across Quantiles (2/3)

- Full-sample spillover index $S_\tau^{(5)}$ at each quantile τ vs the conditional-mean index
  - Source: Ando, Greenwood-Nimmo & Shin (2022)
- U-shaped profile: about 40% in the centre, 88.18% at $\tau = 0.01$, 91.77% at $\tau = 0.99$
  - The mean index (56.57%) describes neither regime: too high for small shocks, too low for large ones

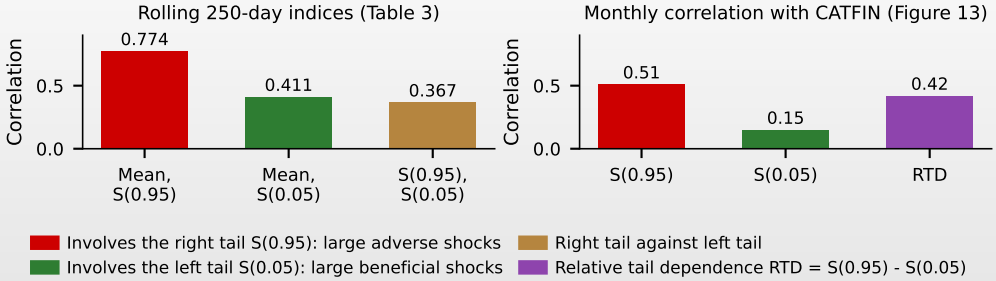
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Spillovers across Quantiles (3/3)

- Full sample: almost symmetric tails, $\mathrm{RTD} = 79.36 - 77.17 = 2.19$ points
  - In rolling windows the asymmetry is stronger and varies (next chart)
- Consequence for stress testing
  - Mean connectedness understates how much of a sector's 5-day forecast error variance comes from other sectors in a crisis

MFM_ch18_quantile_connectedness

The Tails Move Apart (1/2)



- Left: correlations between the rolling indices ($w = 250$ days, $h = 5$); right: monthly correlations with CATFIN; source: Ando, Greenwood-Nimmo & Shin (2022)
- CATFIN: the average of three VaR 1% estimates for financial stocks Allen, Bali & Tang (2012)

MFM_ch18_quantile_connectedness

The Tails Move Apart (2/2)

- The mean index follows the adverse tail (0.774 with $S_{0.95}$) far more than the beneficial tail (0.411 with $S_{0.05}$)
  - A rise in mean connectedness is mainly a rise in bad-news spillovers
- The two tails share little variation (0.367)
  - Two indicators, not one index measured twice
  - Hence RTD is informative: about ± 15 points in rolling windows, against 2.19 on the full sample
- Against CATFIN: 0.51 for $S_{0.95}$, 0.42 for RTD, only 0.15 for $S_{0.05}$
  - CATFIN moves with adverse-shock spillovers more than with beneficial ones (weak bilateral links and the timing of RTD: Appendix)

Extension to Our 13 Banks: Specification and Open Questions

- Course data: daily closes of the 13 banks of this chapter (course dataset; US, euro area and United Kingdom, Romania), 2010–2026; y_t = daily loss $-r_t$ in %, so that the right tail is the adverse one, as for CDS
  - Data limitations: equity losses instead of CDS spreads, 13 banks and no sovereigns ($m = 13$ instead of 34), different closing times of US, European and Romanian markets
- Limits stated by the authors: the lag order of the mean is imposed at every quantile, and the quantile is held fixed along the horizon (other limits: Appendix)
- Open extension
  - Does the RTD of the 13 banks rise before March 2020 and the March 2023 bank failures?
  - Does it predict bank stress beyond current volatility and the mean-based index of this chapter?
  - For forecasting, select lag order and factors on a training sample only

Does Connectedness Warn of Crises, or Only Track Volatility? (1/2)

An open research question: systemic risk or only volatility?

- Connectedness indices are monitored as early-warning tools
  - An index from a VAR on volatilities may co-move with volatility without adding predictive information
  - Live research: regularised VAR networks Demirer et al. (2018); tail connectedness differs from mean connectedness Ando, Greenwood-Nimmo & Shin (2022)

Does Connectedness Warn of Crises, or Only Track Volatility? (2/2)

An open research question: systemic risk or only volatility?

- Formal version: $y_{t+h} = a + \beta_C C_t + \gamma \ln \sigma_t + e_{t+h}$, $H_0 : \beta_C = 0$, $H_1 : \beta_C > 0$
  - y_{t+h}: future bank stress; C_t: total connectedness; σ_t: current volatility
  - Evidence against H_1: the confidence interval (CI) for β_C rules out economically relevant effects; non-significance alone is not enough
- Identification: an edge is a share of forecast error variance, not a causal exposure
  - A common shock raises volatility and connectedness together, with no bank infecting another

The Discovery Loop, Step by Step (1/2)

- **Literature**: map what is known, then verify every reference
  - Resolve each DOI (Digital Object Identifier) on Crossref and check that the paper really controls for volatility; search with Semantic Scholar, Elicit or Google Scholar
- **Hypotheses**: competing readings of a rise in connectedness, each with its own test
  - E.g. a common shock fades with volatility; contagion has a direction: shocks of net transmitters precede those of receivers
- **Data and code**: on the course data, replicating a known number first
  - Replicate first: mean 62.0% and maximum 79.3% (2020-08-27), as in this chapter

The Discovery Loop, Step by Step (2/2)

- **Robustness**, fixed before the predictive regressions are run
  - Every cell of the grid is reported; the family is corrected with Holm or controlled with the FDR (false discovery rate)
- **Critique**: ask the assistant to attack the result
  - Expect: add current volatility as a control, then test the increment of R^2 and of the out-of-sample loss
- **Report**: standardised effects with HAC (heteroskedasticity- and autocorrelation-consistent) t-statistics, every cell of the grid, what failed
  - The prompts that shaped the design go into `AI_USE.md` (reusable prompts and the researcher's checks: Appendix)

Mini-Case: Is Connectedness More Than Volatility? (1/2)

- Typical assistant proposal: "high total connectedness warns of future bank stress"
  - Tested on 731 weekly dates, 2011–2026
  - y_{t+h}: log mean Parkinson volatility of the 13 banks over the next $h = 63$ days; control: the same over the last 20 days
  - Standardised variables; Newey–West with 13 lags, because the 63-day target overlaps across about 13 weeks
- Connectedness alone: $\hat{\beta}_C = 0.40$ ($t = 4.63$), $R^2 = 0.16$: the proposal looks right

Mini-Case: Is Connectedness More Than Volatility? (2/2)

- With current volatility: $\hat{\beta}_C = 0.08$ ($t = 0.75$), $\hat{\gamma} = 0.53$ ($t = 4.13$)
  - $R^2 = 0.343$ vs 0.339 with volatility alone; correlation of C_t with volatility 0.59
  - Next 63-day maximum drawdown: $\hat{\beta}_C = -0.10$ ($t = -1.32$) even as the only regressor
- Interpretation: given current volatility, connectedness adds no significant predictive content
  - Not proof of zero: in our sample the persistence of volatility explains most of the predictive content
  - Network information may still matter in the tails Ando, Greenwood-Nimmo & Shin (2022) or for the direction of transmission

Your Turn: a Project Seed (1/2)

- **Question**
  - Does **tail** connectedness predict bank distress beyond volatility, out of sample?
- **Replicate first**
  - Our rolling index: mean 62.0%, maximum 79.3% (2020-08-27)
  - The six-group connectedness table of Demirer et al. (2018) for 2003–2014: directional entries and row/column totals, with explanations of deviations. The authors publish the replication data (journaldata.zbw.eu)
- **Extend**
  - Quantile connectedness at $\tau = 5\%$ Ando, Greenwood-Nimmo & Shin (2022); out-of-sample evaluation from 2018; MES and SRISK as alternative targets

Your Turn: a Project Seed (2/2)

- **Deliverables**
  - A grid of specifications fixed in writing before the regressions; a notebook that regenerates every number
  - HAC inference and out-of-sample losses for every cell
- **AI log** (templates)
  - `AI_USE.md`: the prompts that shaped the design
  - `AI_ERRORS.md`: each wrong claim (a VAR on price levels, OLS t-statistics on overlapping windows) and the test that caught it

Which Bank Is Most Systemic? (1/3)

Bank	VaR 1%	MES 5%	ΔCoVaR 1%	Net spillover	Λ^*
JPMorgan	4.83	3.22	4.62	9.8	7.0
Bank of America	5.99	3.85	4.60	10.9	6.2
Citigroup	5.87	4.03	3.81	19.0	6.0
Goldman Sachs	4.81	3.34	4.12	2.4	6.8
Morgan Stanley	5.83	4.04	4.00	9.9	6.0
Wells Fargo	5.78	3.32	4.89	3.6	6.8
Deutsche Bank	7.19	4.54	4.24	−12.6	6.1
BNP Paribas	6.18	4.53	4.84	6.0	6.1
Santander	5.83	4.23	4.42	−5.4	6.4
ING	7.16	4.81	4.42	5.2	5.8
HSBC	4.66	2.54	4.07	−23.6	8.3
Banca Transilvania	5.06	3.14	–	−12.2	6.5
BRD-Groupe SG	4.42	2.69	–	−13.0	7.1

- Daily losses in %; net spillover of volatility (to minus from); Λ^*: break-even leverage with $k = 8\%$ and the shortcut LRMES (six-month crisis, market −40%); –: no ΔCoVaR for the two Romanian banks, whose "system" would be a single bank

Which Bank Is Most Systemic? (2/3)

- Rank correlations across the eleven international banks
  - MES and ΔCoVaR: -0.01; MES and net spillover: 0.04
  - ΔCoVaR and net spillover: -0.01; VaR and MES: 0.88

Which Bank Is Most Systemic? (3/3)

- No single ranking
  - Supervisors combine several indicators with size and balance-sheet data, as in the Basel Committee (2018) methodology
- Romanian banks
  - Moderate MES, net receivers of volatility
  - Break-even leverage close to that of US banks

Key Takeaways (1/2)

- Systemic risk lives in the joint tail
  - Exposure (MES, SRISK), contribution (ΔCoVaR), connectedness (spillover and tail networks)
- Euro-area banks: the largest MES in our sample (4.2–4.8%)
  - US banks are the main net transmitters of volatility

Key Takeaways (2/2)

- VaR and ΔCoVaR rank banks differently
  - Rankings are uncertain: test differences, report intervals, state αn
- Market-based measures jump in crises
  - Stress tests and balance sheets are needed to see risk building up
- Romanian banks: mostly their own shocks
  - They receive more volatility spillover than they transmit

Common Pitfalls (1/2)

- Reading ΔCoVaR as causal: a common shock creates the same pattern
- Reading overlapping intervals as "equal" and separate ones as "different"
  - Test the difference on joint draws and correct for the number of pairs (Holm and the joint Wald test)
- Including the bank itself in the system portfolio
  - Its own return adds a mechanical self-contribution to the link

Common Pitfalls (2/2)

- Reading a spillover edge as a causal channel: it is a share of forecast error variance, and a common shock produces it too
- Orthogonal variance decompositions whose results depend on the order of the banks
- Reporting SRISK without balance sheets, or the $1 - e^{-18\mathrm{MES}}$ shortcut as the published measure
- Drawing net labels without intervals

MES as an Euler Contribution: Proof (1/2)

- Portfolio $X_p = \sum_i w_i X_i$ with a continuous distribution; $\mathrm{ES}_\alpha(X_p) = -\mathbb{E}[X_p \mid X_p \le q_\alpha(X_p)]$
  - ES_α is positively homogeneous of degree 1 in w, so by Euler's theorem $\mathrm{ES}_\alpha(X_p) = \sum_i w_i \, \partial \mathrm{ES}_\alpha / \partial w_i$
  - Write $\mathrm{ES}_\alpha = -\frac{1}{\alpha}\mathbb{E}\left[X_p 1\{X_p \le q_\alpha(w)\}\right]$, with f_p the density of X_p
  - The derivative has an interior and a boundary term:
    $$\frac{\partial}{\partial w_i}\mathbb{E}[X_p 1\{X_p \le q_\alpha\}] = \mathbb{E}[X_i 1\{X_p \le q_\alpha\}] + q_\alpha f_p(q_\alpha)\left(\frac{\partial q_\alpha}{\partial w_i} - \mathbb{E}[X_i \mid X_p = q_\alpha]\right)$$
  - The quantile derivative is $\partial q_\alpha / \partial w_i = \mathbb{E}[X_i \mid X_p = q_\alpha]$ Gouriéroux, Laurent & Scaillet (2000), so the boundary term is zero
  - Hence $\partial \mathrm{ES}_\alpha / \partial w_i = -\mathbb{E}[X_i \mid X_p \le q_\alpha(X_p)] = \mathrm{MES}_{i,\alpha}$ with $m = p$ Gouriéroux, Laurent & Scaillet (2000), Scaillet (2004)

Back

MES as an Euler Contribution: Proof (2/2)

- Check on our data: equal-weighted portfolio of the six US banks, $\alpha = 5\%$ (198 tail days)
  - $\mathrm{ES}_{5\%}$ of the portfolio $= 4.32\% =$ average of the six MES conditional on the portfolio (4.32%): exact, also for the historical estimator
  - Conditioning on the S&P 500 instead gives an average MES of 3.63% (JPMorgan: 3.22% vs 3.85%): the identity fails when $m \neq p$
- Under the bivariate Normal distribution with zero means, $\mathrm{MES}_{i,\alpha} = \beta_i \, \mathrm{ES}_\alpha(X_m)$: a beta times a constant

Back

LRMES Simulation: Innovations and Recursions

- Standardised residuals $\epsilon_{it} = r_{it}/\sigma_{it}$, $\epsilon_{mt} = r_{mt}/\sigma_{mt}$; S is their sample correlation matrix, the long-run target of Q_t
  - Bank innovation orthogonal to the market: $\xi_{it} = (\epsilon_{it} - \rho_t\,\epsilon_{mt})/\sqrt{1-\rho_t^2}$ Brownlees & Engle (2017)
- Each simulated day s: draw a past date τ, take the pair $(\xi_{i\tau}, \epsilon_{m\tau})$ and rebuild the bank shock with the **simulated** correlation
  - $\epsilon_{i,t+s} = \rho_{t+s}\,\epsilon_{m\tau} + \sqrt{1-\rho_{t+s}^2}\,\xi_{i\tau}$, then update σ^2 and Q with the new returns
- Restrictions: $\omega > 0$, $\alpha \geq 0$, $\alpha + \gamma \geq 0$, $\beta \geq 0$, $\alpha + \gamma/2 + \beta < 1$ (finite variance for symmetric innovations; in general $\alpha + \gamma\,\mathbb{E}[\epsilon^2 1\{\epsilon < 0\}] + \beta < 1$); $a, b > 0$, $a + b < 1$, so that $\sigma_t^2 > 0$ and Q_t is positive definite
  - Initialisation: $Q_1 = S$ in estimation; the simulation starts from σ^2_{T+1} and Q_{T+1} filtered to the last date

Back

Quantile Regression: Asymptotics

- Asymptotics for a fixed α, with $\hat{\theta}_\alpha = (\hat{a}_\alpha, \hat{b}_\alpha)^\top$, n days, $x_t = (1, X_{i,t})^\top$ and f_t the conditional density of Y at its α-quantile
  - $\sqrt{n}(\hat{\theta}_\alpha - \theta_\alpha) \Rightarrow N\left(0,\ \alpha(1-\alpha)\, D_{\mathbf{1}}^{-\mathbf{1}} D_{\mathbf{0}} D_{\mathbf{1}}^{-\mathbf{1}}\right)$, $D_{\mathbf{0}} = \mathbb{E}[x_t x_t^\top]$, $D_{\mathbf{1}} = \mathbb{E}[f_t\, x_t x_t^\top]$
  - Assumes independent observations (or scores $x_t(\alpha - 1\{u_t < 0\})$ that are a martingale difference), $f_t > 0$ near the quantile and $D_{\mathbf{0}}$, $D_{\mathbf{1}}$ positive definite; with serially dependent scores $D_{\mathbf{0}}$ needs a long-run (HAC) estimate or a block bootstrap
  - The **sparsity** $1/f_t$ must be estimated (kernel or bandwidth); at $\alpha = 1\%$ few observations lie near the quantile, so this estimate is noisy
- The slope b_α can change with α: the bank may matter more for the system in the tail than in the centre

Back

Extremal Quantiles: Why $\alpha = 1\%$ Is Hard

- At $\alpha = 1\%$ only $\alpha n = 40$ days remain in the tail
  - The Normal approximation above assumes $\alpha n \to \infty$ fast; with αn of a few dozen it can be poor, and extremal-quantile theory (extreme-value limits, subsampling) is the alternative built for this case Chernozhukov & Fernández-Val (2011)
- In our data the block-bootstrap standard error of ΔCoVaR 1% is about 0.6 times the kernel-based standard error (median over banks): the two methods give clearly different uncertainty
  - The kernel-based standard error rests on a sparsity estimate from the few observations near the 1% quantile; the bootstrap redraws the same few tail days: neither is reliable when αn is this small
- Practical rule: report $\alpha = 5\%$ and $\alpha = 1\%$ with αn; expect the 1% ranking to be the noisier one
  - The low Spearman correlation between the 1% and 5% rankings (0.10) may reflect estimation noise, genuine differences between the two tail levels, or both

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Testing ΔCoVaR: Three Hypotheses

- (1) $H_0: b_\alpha = 0$ (no contribution)
  - Tests of linear hypotheses across quantiles use the joint asymptotics of $(\hat{b}_\alpha, \hat{b}_{50\%})$ Koenker & Bassett (1982)
- (2) $H_0: b_\alpha = b_{50\%}$ (tail link equal to the central link)
  - We estimate the variance of $\hat{b}_\alpha - \hat{b}_{50\%}$ from 999 moving-block bootstrap draws that keep the pairs of days together
- (3) $H_0: \Delta\mathrm{CoVaR}_i = \Delta\mathrm{CoVaR}_j$ (equal contributions)
  - $z_{ij} = (\widehat{\Delta\mathrm{CoVaR}}_i - \widehat{\Delta\mathrm{CoVaR}}_j)/\widehat{\mathrm{se}}^*$ for each pair, with $\widehat{\mathrm{se}}^*$ the bootstrap standard error of the difference; Holm (1979) correction over the pairs; a joint Wald test that all are equal

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Testing ΔCoVaR 1%: Results

Bank	ΔCoVaR	$\hat{b}_{1\%}$	t	$\hat{b}_{50\%}$	$\hat{b}_{1\%} - \hat{b}_{50\%}$	p
JPMorgan	4.62	0.94	6.9	0.96	−0.02	0.66
Bank of America	4.60	0.76	6.5	0.78	−0.02	0.73
Citigroup	3.81	0.64	4.7	0.76	−0.11	< 0.001
Goldman Sachs	4.12	0.85	5.6	0.84	0.00	0.99
Morgan Stanley	4.00	0.68	4.5	0.73	−0.05	0.28
Wells Fargo	4.89	0.84	4.3	0.78	0.06	0.17
Deutsche Bank	4.24	0.59	4.1	0.60	−0.02	0.67
BNP Paribas	4.84	0.77	6.5	0.74	0.03	0.37
Santander	4.42	0.75	4.5	0.69	0.07	0.07
ING	4.42	0.61	4.4	0.71	−0.10	0.002
HSBC	4.07	0.87	4.0	0.86	0.01	0.96

- t: $\hat{b}_{1\%}$ divided by its kernel (sandwich) standard error, valid only for serially independent scores
- p: p-value of $b_{1\%} = b_{50\%}$ from $z = (\hat{b}_{1\%} - \hat{b}_{50\%})/\widehat{\mathrm{se}}^*$, with the bootstrap standard error $\widehat{\mathrm{se}}^*$ and the Normal approximation
- pair tests and joint Wald tests: main slide

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Time-Varying ΔCoVaR with State Variables

- State variables M_{t-1}: log VIX, the return of the regional index and of the system, all lagged one day Adrian & Brunnermeier (2016)
  - $q_\alpha(X_{i,t} \mid M_{t-1}) = a_i + c_i^\top M_{t-1}$ at α and at 50% (a_i, c_i: intercept and coefficients of the bank's quantile regression)
  - $q_\alpha(X_t^{sys} \mid X_{i,t}, M_{t-1}) = a + b\, X_{i,t} + c^\top M_{t-1}$
- Then $\Delta\mathrm{CoVaR}_{\alpha,t} = \hat{b}\left(\hat{q}_{50\%,t}(X_i) - \hat{q}_{\alpha,t}(X_i)\right)$
  - It moves with the bank's conditional VaR, which moves with the VIX
- The slope $\hat{b}$ is constant: time variation comes from the state, not from the link

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Backtesting CoVaR and MES (1/2)

- Systemic measures are conditional risk measures, so they need **conditional** backtests Banulescu-Radu, Hurlin, Leymarie & Scaillet (2021)
  - For $\mathrm{CoVaR}^{\leq}$: hit $I_t = 1\{X_t^{sys} \leq -\mathrm{CoVaR}_t^{\leq},\ X_{i,t} \leq -\mathrm{VaR}_{i,t}\}$ with $P(I_t = 1) = \alpha^2$ under H_0 if both the bank VaR and the conditional quantile are calibrated
  - The Kupiec test checks that the hit frequency is α^2: with x hits in n days and $\hat{\pi} = x/n$,
    $\mathrm{LR}_{\mathrm{POF}} = -2 \ln \dfrac{(1-\alpha^2)^{n-x}(\alpha^2)^x}{(1-\hat{\pi})^{n-x}\hat{\pi}^x} \sim \chi^2_1$ under H_0 (Chapter 8)
  - The Christoffersen test also checks that hits are independent: a hit today must not make one tomorrow more likely
  - The bank VaR is checked separately, against its own rate α
  - For MES: the cumulative joint violation process of Banulescu-Radu, Hurlin, Leymarie & Scaillet (2021)

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Backtesting CoVaR and MES (2/2)

- Our out-of-sample check: historical $\mathrm{CoVaR}^{\leq}_{5\%}$ on an expanding window from day 1 000, 2 960 forecast days per bank
  - Expected joint hits 7.4; observed 5–9 across the eleven banks (JPMorgan 9); smallest Kupiec $p = 0.35$: no rejection
  - Power is limited: if the true joint rate were twice α^2, the 5% Kupiec test would reject in 62% of samples of this length with independent hits, so even a doubling is missed about one time in three

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VAR Assumptions and the Lag Order of the Rolling Index

- The VAR(p) of From Pairs to Networks
  - Assumptions: stable VAR (roots of $\det(I - \sum_l A_l z^l)$ outside the unit circle), ε_t serially uncorrelated with finite, positive definite Σ
  - Moving-average form: $y_t = \mu + \sum_{h \geq \mathbf{0}} \Phi_h \varepsilon_{t-h}$, $\Phi_\mathbf{0} = I$, $\Phi_h = \sum_{l=\mathbf{1}}^{p} A_l \Phi_{h-l}$ ($\Phi_h = 0$ for $h < 0$); e_i: the i-th unit vector
- Lag order: every window keeps $p = 2$, the order BIC selects on the full sample; in the windows BIC picks $p = 1$ every time, and with $p = 1$ the index has correlation 0.99 with the one shown

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Regularised VARs: the Elastic Net (1/2)

- Demirer et al. (2018): each VAR equation by the adaptive elastic net, λ chosen equation by equation by 10-fold cross-validation
  - $\hat{\beta} = \arg\min_\beta \sum_t \left(y_t - \sum_i \beta_i x_{it}\right)^2 + \lambda \sum_i w_i \left(\frac{1}{2}|\beta_i| + \frac{1}{2}\beta_i^2\right)$, $w_i = 1/|\hat{\beta}_{i,\mathrm{OLS}}|$
  - x_{it}: the lagged series (regressors); λ: penalty strength; w_i: adaptive weights, larger for coefficients small in OLS; the $|\beta_i|$ part sets coefficients to zero, the β_i^2 part shrinks them
  - Rolling windows of 150 days with the plain elastic net, $w_i = 1$; forecast horizon $H = 10$

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Regularised VARs: the Elastic Net (2/2)

- Why: selection and shrinkage in the VAR coefficients, without forcing a sparse **network** (links also come through Σ)
  - On the full sample we keep the BIC order of our OLS VAR, $p = 2$
  - In the 150-day rolling comparison both OLS and elastic net use $p = 1$ (chart legend), the order BIC selects in 100% of the rolling windows
- With about 4 000 days the penalty hardly matters (full-sample C in the main text); it matters in short windows

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Granger-Causality Networks and Multiple Testing (1/2)

- Billio, Getmansky, Lo & Pelizzon (2012) draw an edge $j \to i$ when j Granger-causes i at 5%; with 13 banks this is $13 \times 12 = 156$ tests
  - j Granger-causes i if the past of j improves the forecast of i: in $X_{i,t} = c + aX_{i,t-\mathbf{1}} + gX_{j,t-\mathbf{1}} + u_t$ we test $H_{\mathbf{0}}: g = 0$
  - Even with no links at all, about 7.8 edges would appear by chance

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Granger-Causality Networks and Multiple Testing (2/2)

- Our tests: bivariate regressions, one lag, heteroskedasticity-robust Wald statistics
  - Daily returns: 57 edges at 5%, 33 after the Holm (1979) correction, 55 with the false discovery rate controlled at 5% Benjamini & Hochberg (1995)
  - Log volatility, highly persistent: one extra lag that is not tested Toda & Yamamoto (1995), as in the lag-augmented tests of Shi, Hurn & Phillips (2020): 153, 150 and 153 edges
- Holm controls the chance of any false edge under arbitrary dependence; the FDR is the **expected** share of false edges among those drawn, and the BH (Benjamini–Hochberg) procedure guarantees it for independent tests Benjamini & Hochberg (1995), while tests on overlapping bank pairs are dependent
- Daily returns of banks in different time zones: many "causal" edges only reflect that New York closes after Frankfurt

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Worked Example: Reverse Stress Test with Two Factors

- Betas $b = (1.2, 0.8)$; four-week covariance of the factors $h\Sigma = \begin{pmatrix} 16 & 6 \\ 6 & 9 \end{pmatrix}$ (%²); target loss $\ell^* = 20\%$
  - $h\Sigma\, b = (1.2 \cdot 16 + 0.8 \cdot 6,\ 1.2 \cdot 6 + 0.8 \cdot 9) = (24, 14.4)$
  - $b^\top h\Sigma\, b = 1.2 \cdot 24 + 0.8 \cdot 14.4 = 40.32$, standard deviation 6.35%
- Most plausible scenario and its distance
  - $f^* = -20 \cdot (24, 14.4)/40.32 = (-11.9\%, -7.1\%), \quad d^* = 20/6.35 = 3.15$
  - Normal probability of a loss at least this large: $\Phi(-3.15) = 0.08\%$ per four weeks
- The scenario loads more on the factor with the larger beta and variance, and both factors fall together because they are correlated

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Sectors, Factors and Lag Order

- Data (Section 3): the 17 financial sectors
  - A financial sector = equal-weighted CDS of its banks and insurers with assets of at least USD 10 billion, 199 institutions in all
- Factors (Eq. (8), Figure 2)
  - Residual pairs with $|\rho| < 0.25$: 91.6% with factors, fewer than half without
- Lag order and horizon (Sections 2.2 and 4)
  - VAR(1) chosen by BIC at the mean and kept at every quantile; $h = 5$ days; the quantile is held fixed along the forecast horizon

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Further Results

- Of the 1 122 bilateral spillovers, 568 are below 1% at the mean and 829 at the median (Figure 7)
  - Away from the mean, the network has many weak links rather than a few strong ones; in the tails these weak links add up to strong average spillovers
- RTD over time (Section 4.3, Figure 11)
  - RTD rises with the Bear Stearns fund losses of 2007 and falls after the US bank rescue programme and the negative rates of the ECB: a fragility signal the mean hides

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Replication Specification and Limits Stated by the Authors

- Specification for the replication on the 13 banks
  - VAR order by BIC, factors by Eq. (8), $h = 5$, $\tau \in \{0.05, 0.5, 0.95\}$ and the mean, $w = 250$, RTD
- Further limits stated by the authors
  - 250 days are too few to select factors window by window, so their number is fixed (Section 4.3, Appendix B of the paper); shorter windows leave too few effective tail observations
  - Only direct spillovers of idiosyncratic shocks are measured, not propagation through the common factors (footnote 2)
  - Greece is left out for a gap in its CDS data (Section 3, Appendix A of the paper)

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The Discovery Loop, Reusable Prompts (1/2)

- **Literature**: map what is known, then verify every reference
  - "Which papers test whether connectedness indices predict bank distress out of sample, beyond volatility? Give DOI, sample, horizon and controls."
- **Hypotheses**: competing readings of a rise in connectedness, each with its own test
  - "Give competing interpretations of a rise in total connectedness (common shock, contagion, artefact of rolling windows) and a test that discriminates between them."

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The Discovery Loop, Reusable Prompts (2/2)

- **Data and code**: on the course data, replicating a known number first
  - "Fit a VAR(2) to the log Parkinson volatilities of the 13 banks of the course data on 250-day windows and compute the generalized total connectedness with H = 10."
- **Robustness**, fixed before the predictive regressions are run
  - "Pre-register: horizons 21/63/126 days, volatility and VIX controls, windows 150/250/500 days, HAC lags at least the overlap, out-of-sample evaluation from 2018."
- **Critique**: ask the assistant to attack the result
  - "Act as a referee: is the predictive power of connectedness just the persistence of volatility? Which regression would show it?"

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What the Researcher Must Check (1/2)

- **Non-stationary inputs**: a VAR on price levels, or on trending series, produces spurious connectedness
  - Test: unit-root tests on every input; all eigenvalues of the companion matrix of the fitted VAR strictly inside the unit circle in every window
- **Ordering**: Cholesky decompositions change with the order of the banks
  - Test: permute the columns; the generalized table must not change

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What the Researcher Must Check (2/2)

- **Look-ahead**: a window labelled by its first date, or a lag order chosen on the full sample
  - Test: the index at t must not move when data after t are deleted
- **Overlap**: rolling indices and forward outcomes overlap, so OLS t-statistics are inflated
  - Test: Newey–West lags at least equal to the overlap, or a block bootstrap
- **Dimension**: 13 banks and $p = 2$ give 27 coefficients per equation from 250 days; more banks need shrinkage Demirer et al. (2018)
  - Test: compare with a LASSO VAR; unstable edges signal estimation noise, not structure

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Further Study on Quantinar

Advanced courses on quantinar.com

- Financial Risk Meter for Emerging Markets
- Dynamic Crypto Networks
- Network Centrality

Code and data

- Quantlets: github.com/danpele/MFM/tree/main/Quantlets/Ch_18

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Acronyms used in this material (1/2)

- **AI**: Artificial Intelligence
- **BAC**: Bank of America Corporation (NYSE ticker)
- **BET**: Bucharest Exchange Trading (index)
- **BH**: Benjamini–Hochberg (procedure)
- **BIC**: Bayesian Information Criterion
- **BNP**: BNP Paribas SA (Euronext Paris ticker; Banque Nationale de Paris)
- **BVB**: Bursa de Valori București — *the Bucharest Stock Exchange*
- **CATFIN**: CATastrophic risk in the FINancial sector
- **CDS**: Credit Default Swap
- **CI**: Confidence Interval
- **COVID-19**: COronaVIrus Disease 2019
- **CV**: Cross-Validation
- **DBK**: Deutsche Bank AG (Xetra ticker)
- **DCC**: Dynamic Conditional Correlation
- **EBA**: European Banking Authority
- **ECB**: European Central Bank
- **ES**: Expected Shortfall
- **EU**: European Union
- **FDIC**: Federal Deposit Insurance Corporation
- **FDR**: False Discovery Rate
- **FEVD**: Forecast Error Variance Decomposition
- **FRM**: Financial Risk Meter
- **GAAP**: Generally Accepted Accounting Principles (US)
- **GACV**: Generalized Approximate Cross-Validation
- **GARCH**: Generalised AutoRegressive Conditional Heteroskedasticity
- **GFC**: Global Financial Crisis (2007–2009)

Acronyms used in this material (2/2)

- **GJR**: Glosten–Jagannathan–Runkle (asymmetric GARCH)
- **GS**: The Goldman Sachs Group, Inc. (NYSE ticker)
- **HAC**: Heteroskedasticity and Autocorrelation Consistent (standard errors)
- **HSBA**: HSBC Holdings plc (London Stock Exchange ticker)
- **HSBC**: HSBC Holdings plc (originally the Hongkong and Shanghai Banking Corporation)
- **IFRS**: International Financial Reporting Standards
- **ING**: ING Groep (Internationale Nederlanden Groep) — *the Dutch banking group ING*
- **INGA**: ING Groep N.V. (Euronext Amsterdam ticker)
- **JPM**: JPMorgan Chase & Co. (NYSE ticker)
- **LASSO**: Least Absolute Shrinkage and Selection Operator
- **LRMES**: Long-Run Marginal Expected Shortfall
- **MES**: Marginal Expected Shortfall
- **MS**: Morgan Stanley (NYSE ticker)
- **OLS**: Ordinary Least Squares
- **QFVAR**: Quantile Factor Vector AutoRegression
- **QML**: Quasi-Maximum Likelihood
- **RTD**: Relative Tail Dependence
- **SAN**: Banco Santander SA (Bolsa de Madrid ticker)
- **SG**: Société Générale — *the French banking group Société Générale*
- **SRISK**: Systemic RISK (capital shortfall measure)
- **SVB**: Silicon Valley Bank
- **TENET**: Tail-Event driven NETwork risk
- **TLV**: Banca Transilvania (BVB ticker)
- **US**: United States
- **VAR**: Vector AutoRegression
- **VIX**: CBOE Volatility IndeX
- **WFC**: Wells Fargo & Company (NYSE ticker)

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